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PARLIAMENTARY DEBATES

OFFICIAL REPORT

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THE
PARLIAMENT OF THE REPUBLIC
OF GHANA

FIRST MEETING, 2026

Friday, 20th February, 2026

*The House met at the Chamber,
Parliament House, at 1:04 p.m.*

[HON FIRST DEPUTY SPEAKER,
MR BERNARD AHIAFOR, IN THE
CHAIR]

[PRAYERS]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, we have to correct the *Votes and Proceedings*. But before that, I think we are masters of our own rules, but, yesterday, we allowed a Member to read a Statement for and on behalf of another Member. The rules are clear when it comes to Questions, that a Member with an authority can ask the Question for and on behalf of a Member who is not readily available at the Chamber. Members in exercising that right, have been quoting the relevant rules.

Hon Members, with all due respect, the rules that govern Statements start from Order 91 to 93. No provision is made in the rules for a Member to make Statements on behalf of another Member. Statements are of an urgent or personal nature to that Member. I believe it is for that reason that there is no provision in our Standing Order that enables a Member to make Statements on behalf of another Member.

Flowing from the exceptional circumstances that happened yesterday, it is important to place on record that our Standing Order is under review. Going forward, if that is what the House agreed upon, then the Standing Orders Committee must take it into consideration; else, that should not serve as a precedent. Acting as masters of our own rules, the exceptional circumstances that warranted us to allow a Member to make Statements on behalf of another Member, should not serve as precedent going forward.

Hon Members, it is important we take note of this. Hon Members, until a possible amendment to the Standing Orders comes into force, this definitely will not serve as a precedent.

**VOTES AND PROCEEDINGS AND
THE OFFICIAL REPORT**

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Now, I hold in my hand the *Votes and Proceedings* of Thursday, 19th February, 2026, for correction.

Page 1...3—

Yes, Mr Vincent Ekow Assafuah?

Mr Vincent Ekow Assafuah: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

On the page numbered 3, the item numbered 118, the name as written Drah Emmanuel is a Member of Parliament for Upper West Akim. The name of the Constituency as written, “Upperwest” has been spelled as one word. It is supposed to be separate words.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Table, kindly take note.

Page 4...7—

Yes, Hon Member?

Mr Frank Afriyie: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, with respect, on the page numbered 7, the item numbered 5, under the heading “COMMUNICATION FROM THE SPEAKER”—If you read through the information that came to the House yesterday, I hold the opinion that the heading should be “Communication from H.E. the President.”

Mr Speaker, let me read;

“The Rt Hon Speaker read a Communication dated Monday, 16th February, 2026 from the Secretary to the President, Dr Callistus Mahama, to the Clerk to Parliament, informing the Speaker and the House...”

So, my emphasis is on the one who sent the letter and the fact that it is informing the Speaker and the House. So, I think that the heading, should be written as “Communication from H. E the President” rather than the Speaker.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Table, take note.

Yes, Hon Member, the position in the *Votes and Proceedings* is correct. The communication emanating from the Speaker is not signed by the President. That is why it is not Communication from His Excellency, the President. So, the correct position has been captured. The letter was signed by the Secretary to the President, addressed to the Clerk; it was not signed by the President, addressed to the Speaker. So that is the difference.

Yes, Hon Member?

Mr Assafuah: Mr Speaker, just a bit of guidance.

1:15 p.m.

Mr Vincent Ekow Assafuah: Yesterday, I was here when the Rt Hon Speaker mentioned on the *Order Paper* that he was taking the item numbered 3, which was “Message from the President.” So, if we know that there is a message from the President and we can rightly capture it as a “Message from the President”, so we actually know that it is a Message from the President.

Maybe I would side with my Hon Brother when he wants the heading to be changed but I also agree with what you said, that it is a Communication from the Speaker. But if I want to quote what the Speaker himself said, he mentioned he is taking the item numbered 3, which was “Message from the President.”

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Page 6 — Yes, Dr Anabah?

Dr Thomas Winsum Anabah: Mr Speaker, page 6, the item numbered 4, number two, Hon Isaac Adongo, Member of Parliament for Bolgatanga Central, was in the Chamber because I came in with him, but I have seen his name as absent.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Table Office, take note.

Page 7 — Yes, Nana Asafo-Adjei Ayeh?

Nana Asafo-Adjei Ayeh: Mr Speaker, respectfully, I seek your advice and guidance. On page 7, item 3, Asante Laurette Korkor was behind me yesterday and I have drawn her attention and she confirmed she was here, but her name is captured under “Absent”. I do not know if there is a guideline to go about it, since the Member is not here herself during the correction of the *Votes and Proceedings*.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, what guidance are you seeking?

Mr Ayeh: That if I can do that on her behalf and draw the attention of the House —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: But you saw the Hon Member who did for Hon Adongo. So, if you are correcting, you just go and correct the *Votes and Proceedings* without necessarily saying you are seeking guidance from me. How do I guide you?

Mr Ayeh: Mr Speaker, Hon Asante Laurette Korkor, MP for Atiwa West, was present yesterday, but her name has been marked as absent.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Table, take note.

Page 8...10 — Yes, Mr Afriyie?

Mr Frank Afriyie: Mr Speaker, on page 9, item 9(b), line 2, I submit and suggest that we insert the Hon Member’s name after New Juaben South. That is Hon Michael Baafi Okyere.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Table, take note.

Page 10, 11 — Yes, Hon Assafuah?

Mr Assafuah: Mr Speaker, on page 10, item numbered 10, under Motions, GNPC Exploration and Production Limited. The word “Company|” is missing because on other pages, you could see “Company” also there.

Mr Speaker, if we also check the item numbered 11, they also misarranged the words “Company Limited.” It was made “Limited Company”. So, if the Table can also take the arrangement into consideration.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Table, make sure the Motion in the *Order Paper* is what is captured. The correct rendition is in the *Order Paper* for yesterday. So, just cross-check the name of the company.

Page 11, 12 — Yes, Hon Assafuah?

Mr Assafuah: Mr Speaker, a similar correction is on page 11. That would have to be done. Apart from that, Petro S.A. on other pages, it is one word. But in this part, that is page 11, item number 13, under “Resolution”, number 2, Petro S.A. is indicated as two separate words.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Table, take note.

Page 12...16 — Yes, Prof Kingsley Nyarko?

Prof Kingsley Nyarko: Mr Speaker, on page 13, there is a minor observation at the apex of the page, “Terms of the West Cape Three Points”. If we come to page 10, we also see under “Motions” West Cape Three Points”, But if we look at the second paragraph on page 13 —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Table kindly reconcile the name.

Prof Nyarko: No, not the name. So, if we come to the second paragraph, it is West Cape Three Point. It should be “Points”.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Kingsley Nyarko, what exactly do you want corrected?

Prof Nyarko: I am saying that it should be “West Cape Three Points” but on other pages, it is “West Cape Three Point”.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: That is why I asked the Table to reconcile and you asked me to wait.

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, just indulge me to make my point clear because I have not concluded. The point I am making is that it should be “West Cape Three Points”. So anywhere we see the “Point”, we make it plural, simple.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, let us take note that it is time for correction of *Votes and Proceedings*. It is not the period for which you have to make your points. If you reduce the correction of *Votes and Proceedings* to a period of making points, then we would have been deviating. So, what exactly you want to be corrected, that is what you suggest. Then I will ask the Table to cross-check and do the needful.

Yes, Hon Assafuah?

Mr Assafuah: On page 14, the item numbered 2, the second paragraph should read, “This House in accordance with the said Article 268(1)1 of the Constitution hereby resolves...” The last “s” is missing.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Please, Table, take note.

Page 16,17 — Yes, Hon Assafuah?

Mr Assafuah: Page 16, item number 3, in attendance, small letter “r” was used for “retired”. It is supposed to be capital “R”.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you. Table, take note.

Yes, Prof Nyarko?

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, page 17, items iv and vi, I see Dr Benjamin Bewa-Nyog Kunbuor, resource person, University of Ghana School of Law. Resource person to whom? Is it to the Committee or to the sponsors? So, I need clarity on that. Then when we come to item vi, Major General Emmanuel Kotia (Rtd), resource person, no designation. So, we need that information.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, I think this is implied. So, I do not see it as a problem.

Page 18...20 — Yes, Prof Nyarko?

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, I have observed something. On attendance, Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor was present but the one who chaired the meeting was the Second Deputy Majority Whip but the Majority Chief Whip was there.

Mr Speaker, page 20 —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I did not get it. What is the problem?

Prof Nyarko: I am saying that I need clarity on why the Majority Chief Whip was there, but the Second Deputy Majority Whip chaired the Meeting. Then under “In Attendance”, I see “Ms Abigail Yaa Awuku – Executive Officer”. Where is she from?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: *Votes and Proceedings* are supposed to capture what happened at the meeting. So, if they are communicating to us that it was Mr Richard Acheampong who chaired the meeting, which is the correct position that they are communicating, what is the issue? The Clerk-at-the-Table is telling me that the meeting was chaired by Mr Richard Acheampong.

Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I am a Member of the Business Committee and I dutifully attend meetings. On the said day, this is the fact, Mr Acheampong started it, but it was Mr Dafeamekpor who came in after, chaired the meeting and concluded. Mr Speaker, I am saying this is not correct.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: If the communication from the Committee to the Clerk, which was captured by the *Votes and Proceedings*, is saying that Mr Acheampong chaired the meeting, what have they done wrong?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, what we are doing is correcting the *Votes and Proceedings*. I was a living witness, so I am saying what has been communicated is not correct. It was Mr Dafeamekpor who chaired it and concluded the meeting.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: My understanding of correction of *Votes and Proceedings* is not about how correct the incidence is, but how factual and appropriate it is. So, from your narration, Mr Acheampong started the meeting, so if the record that was transmitted indicates Mr Acheampong, but never

later said that Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor later came to take over, what should be captured is the communication that has come to them. We cannot correct it using the *Votes and Proceedings*.

For instance, the announcement that I just made on a Member making a Statement on behalf of another, it is correct. But same has actually been captured by the Order Paper, so we cannot do the correction per the Order Paper.

Hon Members, the *Votes and Proceedings* of Thursday, 19th February, 2026, as corrected is hereby adopted as the true record of proceedings.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: In the absence of the *Official Report*, let us move to the item numbered 6, Business Statement for the fourth week. I will call on the Chairperson of the Business Committee, who also doubles as the Majority Leader and Leader of Government Business, to present the Business Statement.

BUSINESS OF THE HOUSE

Majority Leader/Leader of Government Business (Mr Mahama Ayariga):

Introduction

Mr Speaker, the Committee met yesterday, Thursday, 19th February, 2026 and arranged Business of the House for the Fourth Week ending Friday, 27th February, 2026.

Mr Speaker, the Committee accordingly submits its report as follows:

Arrangement of Business

Formal Communications by the Speaker

Mr Speaker, you may read any available communication to the House.

Question(s)

Mr Speaker, the Business Committee has scheduled the following ministers to respond to Questions asked of them during the Week:

Number of Question(s)

Attorney-General and Minister for Justice	2
Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources	10
Minister for Roads and Highways	10
Minister for Youth Development and Empowerment	3
Minister for Government Communications	2

Minister for Lands and Natural Resources

7**Total Number of Questions**34

Mr Speaker, in all, six (6) Ministers are expected to attend upon the House to respond to thirty-four (34) Questions during the Week. The Questions are of the following types:

- i. Urgent – 0;
- ii. Oral – 34

Statements

Mr Speaker, pursuant to Order 91(2) of the Standing Orders of Parliament, Ministers of State may be permitted to make Statements on Government policy. You may also admit Statements by Hon Members in accordance with Order 93 of the Standing Orders of Parliament.

Guidelines on Making Statements

Mr Speaker, the Committee deliberated extensively on the guidelines for the presentation of Statements because that has become a major problem in this Chamber. The Business Committee once again reminds Hon Members on the guidelines to making Statements in the House. Hon Ministers are expected to deliver Statements within 15 minutes and Hon Members, excluding Leaders are to deliver the Statements within 10 minutes. Pursuant to Order 93(5) of the Standing Orders of Parliament, a Member may comment on a Statement for a period not exceeding 5 minutes. Attached is a detailed Guidelines to making Statements.

Bills, Papers and Reports

Mr Speaker, in accordance with Order 159 of the Standing Orders of Parliament, Bills may be presented to the House for First Reading. However, those of urgent nature may be taken through the various stages in a day in accordance with Order 160 of the Standing Orders of Parliament.

Pursuant to Order 97 of the Standing Orders of Parliament, Papers may be laid during the week and reports from Committees may also be presented to the House for consideration.

Motions and Resolutions

Mr Speaker, Motions may be debated and their consequential Resolutions, if any, taken during the week.

Address by H. E. the President

Mr Speaker, Hon Members are reminded that H. E. the President of the Republic is scheduled to deliver a Message on the State of the Nation on Friday, 27th February, 2026 at 10:00 a.m. in accordance with Article 67 of the Constitution.

In line with the convention of the House, Hon Members are urged to be punctual and seated in the Chamber by 9:15 a.m. as it is inappropriate for

Members to enter or exit the Chamber after H. E. the President has entered the House to deliver his address.

Mr Speaker, in view of the President's Address on Friday, the House will sit at 10:00 a.m. on Thursday, 26th February, 2026, to enable the House adjourn early in preparation for the Address.

Referrals at Committee

Mr Speaker, the Business Committee, is once again publishing the backlog of referrals before Committees and urges Leadership of Committees to prioritise and expedite consideration of the referrals and promptly report to the House in accordance with Order 267 (4) of the Standing Orders of Parliament.

In view of this, Mr Speaker, an updated breakdown of pending referrals at Committee has been attached for the attention of leadership of the respective Committees. A total of 294 referrals have been assigned to 24 Committees for consideration and report to the House.

Joint Caucus Meeting

Mr Speaker, the Committee has programmed a Joint Caucus meeting on Wednesday, 25th February, 2026, to discuss pertinent issues of concern to Hon Members.

Conclusion

Mr Speaker, in accordance with Order 216 (2) and subject to Order 67 of the Standing Orders of Parliament, the Committee submits to the House the

order in which the Business of the House shall be taken during the week.

Tuesday, 24th February, 2026

Roll Call

National Pledge

Statements

Mr Solomon Kuyon (Krachi Nchumuru): To make a Statement on the urgent need for a National Youth Development Fund.

Ms Felicia Adjei (Kintampo South): To make a Statement on Proportional Representation and its role in promoting Gender Equity in Governance.

Ms Phillis Naa Koryoo Okunor (Awutu Senya East): To make a Statement on Introduction of Malaria Vaccines.

Questions

***611. Mr Akwasi Konadu (Manhyia North):** To ask the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice the status of the investigation of Joseph Yamin and Yakubu Abanga on their alleged involvement in illegal mining activities.

***647. Mr Haruna Seidu (Wenchi):** To ask the Attorney General and Minister for Justice when the completed high court building and bungalows for judges in Wenchi will be operationalised and occupied, respectively.

***318. Ms Gloria Owusu (Trobu):** To ask the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources the measures being taken to complete all outstanding drainage works in the Trobu Constituency to avoid loss of lives and property when it rains.

***369. Mr Michael Okyere Baafi (New Juaben South):** To ask the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources the specific nature and purpose of the ongoing work by the Ghana Water Company which has deteriorated the asphalted Koforidua township roads constructed by the previous administration.

***388. Mr Maxwell Kwame Lukutor (South Tongu):** To ask the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources the current state of the Agordomi Water Expansion Project in the South Tongu Constituency which is expected to supply water to other parts of the country and Togo.

***441. Mr Ralph Poku-Adusei (Bekwai):** To ask the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources what concrete plans are being implemented to attract private sector participation in housing delivery including partnership with the Ghana Real Estate Developers Association (GREDA) to address the housing needs of low and middle income earners.

***505. Mr Charles Forson (Tema Central):** To ask the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources the underlying reasons why water do not

flow through our taps within the Constituency in continuum.

***506. Mr Felix Akwetey Okle (Bortianor-Ngleshie Amanfro):** To ask the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources the measures being taken to construct all outstanding drainages in the Bortianor-Ngleshie Amanfro Constituency.

***507. Mr Martin Adjei-Mensah Korsah (Techiman South):** To ask the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources how the Government intends to fund the operationalisation of the District Road Improvement Programme (DRIP) within the assemblies.

***575. Mr Alexander Akwasi Acquah (Akim Oda):** To ask the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources when the Ghana Hydrological Authority will pay attention to the construction works that started contaminating the Musuku River within the Kwabenya –Ashongman environs.

***589. Mr Nelson Kofi Djabab (Krachi East):** To ask the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources when the Dambai Water Project will commence.

***624. Mr Sanja Nanja (Atebubu/Amantin):** To ask the Minister for Works, Housing and Water Resources what measures are being implemented to curb the perennial water crisis in the Atebubu Township.

Presentation of Papers**Presentation and First Reading of Bills**

Value for Money Office Bill, 2026
Motions

Third Reading of Bills

Ghana Deposit Protection
(Amendment) Bill, 2025.

Consideration Stage

Ghana Deposit Protection
(Amendment) Bill, 2025.

Committee sittings.

Wednesday, 25th February, 2026

Roll Call

Statements

Mr Alhassan Umar (Zabzugu): To make a statement on the urgent need to address Deceptive Warranty Practices and Strengthen Consumer Rights Protection in Ghana.

Mr Vincent Ekow Assafuah (Old Tafo): To make a statement on the maintenance culture of all stadia in Ghana.

Ms Emelia Ankomah (Upper Denkyira East): To make a statement on the International Day of Zero Tolerance for Female Genital Mutilation.

Questions

***584. Mr Kwame Anyimadu-Antwi (Asante Akim Central):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the Konongo Zongo to Praaso through Dwease road will be completed.

***551. Dr Grace Ayensu-Danquah (Essikado Ketan):** To ask the Minister of Roads and Highways the status of the following roads: (i) Kansawrodo – Mampong – Abaasa (ii) Mpinstin – Eshien – Ntamakrom – Angu.

***552. Mr Felix Akwetey Okle (Bortianor Ngleshie Amanfro):** To ask the Minister of Roads and Highways the steps being implemented to complete the inner road projects in Bortianor Ngleshie Amanfro which were started under the previous Government.

***580. Mr Bright Asamoah Brefo (Bibiani / Anhwiaso/ Bekwai):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways the steps the Ministry is taking to ensure the timely completion of the ongoing projects in Bibiani and Sefwi-Bekwai.

***597. Alhaji Alhassan Mumuni (Salaga North):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways the steps the Ministry is implementing to fix the following roads: (i) Kpalbe – Vanne road (ii) Kpalbe – Jinlo road (iii) Tantuani – Kpalguni road.

***610. Dr Godfred Seidu Jasaw (Wa East):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when rehabilitation works will commence on the following

roads: (i) Wa –Bulenga – Kundugu (ii) Wa – Loggu – Jeyiri – Tuosa

***613. Ms Shirley Kyei (Atwima Nwabiagya South):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when construction works will resume on the following roads: (i) Wiosu – Amanchia (ii) Nkawie – Nkranfoase (iii) Ntabanum Junction – Ntabanum.

***619. Dr Albert Tetteh Nyakotey (Yilo Krobo):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when work on the Somanya to Kpong road will resume after the contractor abandoned the project in January 2025.

***634. Mr Kofi Arko Nokoe (Evalua Ajomoro Gwira):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the Gwira Wiaso – Gwira Maham bridge over the River Ankobra linking the Evalua and Nzema areas in the South to the Gwira and Wassa North will be constructed.

***640. Mr Tweneboah Kodua Fokua (Manso Nkwanta):** To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways why the upgrading of Pakyi No. 2 – Antoakrom feeder road (21.30km), Trede – Pakyi No. 2 link (2.40km) and critical access (0.95km) have halted and the contractor has vacated the site.

***192. Mr Vincent Ekow Assafuah (Old Tafo):** To ask the Minister for Youth Development and Empowerment what specific measures the Ministry has instituted to address the growing “wonim red” trend among the youth, which many regard as a threat to

discipline, morality and responsible citizenship in Ghana.

***352 Mr Abdul-Fatawu Alhassan (Yendi):** To ask the Minister for Youth Development and Empowerment the plans of the government to complete the Yendi Youth Resource Centre which is also known as the Yendi Stadium.

***648. Mr Isaac Boamah-Nyarko (Effia):** To ask the Minister for Youth Development and Empowerment when the 300 staff recruited under the Youth Empowerment Agency (YEA) in December 2024 will begin receiving their salaries.

***96. Mr Vincent Ekow Assafuah (Old Tafo):** To ask the Minister of State in charge of Government Communication the total cost of all committees formed by the President and his Ministers and the sources of funding since the expenditure was not included in the first-quarter budget approved by Parliament.

***535. Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh (Nsawam-Adoagyiri):** To ask the Minister for Government Communications, the full details of the Government Advisory Council which was set up upon the invitation of the President to representatives of Civil Society Organisations (CSOs) in Ghana, and what this auxiliary body is costing the taxpayer.

Motions

Committee sittings.

Joint Caucus Meeting

Thursday, 26th February, 2026

Roll Call

Statements

Mr Kofi Arko Nokoe (Evalue Ajomoro Gwira): To make a Statement on the State of Housing in Ghana and the need for a National Affordable Housing Fund Act.

Dr Fred Kyei Asamoah (Offinso North): To make a Statement on the persistent and escalating threat of Highway Robbery on our roads in Ghana.

Mr Maxwell Kwame Lukutor (South Tongu): To make a Statement on the Deteriorating State of the Sogakope Bridge and the urgent need for comprehensive maintenance and rehabilitation.

Questions

***547. Mr Akwasi Konadu (Manhyia North):** To ask the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources the legal mandate, institutional structure and operational scope of the Blue Water Guards recently deployed by the Ministry and how effective they have been in protecting Ghana's river and water bodies from the continued destruction caused by illegal mining (galamsey) activities

***353. Mr Duke William Allen Kwame Amoako-Atta Ofori-Atta**

(Fanteakwa South): To ask the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources the plans of the Ministry to provide Fanteakwa South with tree lots under the "Tree for Life Initiative".

***456. Alhaji Nurideen Muhammed Mumuni (Nalerigu/Gambaga):** To ask the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources the number of excavators that have been seized by the Ministry since the assumption of office of the Minister.

***461. Dr Ebenezer Prince Arhin (Mfantseman):** To ask the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources the plans the Ministry is implementing to facilitate the ratification of the Ewoyaa Lithium Agreement in the Mfantseman Constituency.

***518. Mr Francis Kwabena Owusu Akyaw (Juaben):** To ask the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources what steps the Ministry has implemented in strengthening minerals exploration and resources estimates for the small-scale miners.

***548. Mr Issah Salifu Taylor (Tarkwa/Nsuaem):** To ask the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources to provide an update on the status of the refinery project by the Ghana Manganese Company Limited at the Nsuta site in Tarkwa Nsuaem and when the final approval from the Government will be granted to commerce operations.

***497. Mr Isaac Boamah-Nyarko (Effia):** To ask the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources how many excavations have been seized since

January 2025, the number missing or unaccounted for and what measures the Ministry is putting in place to regulate the increasing importation of excavators into the country.

Presentation of Papers

Motions

Committee sittings.

Friday, 27th February, 2026

Roll Call

Statements

MESSAGE ON THE STATE OF THE NATION BY H. E. THE PRESIDENT

Questions

Motions

Committee sittings.

1:35 p.m.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the Business Statement is ably presented by the Chairperson of the Business Committee. The floor is now open for comments.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, let me have the singular honour to commend you. Your *fugu* is spot on, and your hat is properly worn. This is an indication that you are a true grandson of the Yaa Naa. You have been properly

taught, and I think Colleagues should take a cue, especially my classmate, the Deputy Minister for Agriculture —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: But Hon Habib, why are you referring to me as a grandson instead of a son?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I think the last time you said you were a grandson.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: No, I am a son of the Yaa Naa. Am I not older than some of his children?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, the way you are dressed, even if you say you are a cousin to the Yaa Naa, it might be acceptable.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: You are still reducing my status. *[Laughter]*

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, in fact, the way you are dressed, even though you are seated, anybody who chances upon you will conclude that you are a true grandson —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: True son.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, true son of the Yaa Naa.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: And you are spot on. I know that you are spiritually fortified in so many things with the way you are dressed. Mr Speaker, I was only saying that Hon Members should take a cue from the way you are dressed, especially my classmates, the Deputy

Minister for Agriculture, Hon John Dumelo.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, Hon Habib Iddrisu, is that your comment on the Business Statement?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I just want to commend the way you are dressed. On the Business Statement, I would want to draw the attention of the Majority Leader to page 5. Mr Speaker, on page 5, which is on Friday 27th February, 2026, he only mentioned Roll call, Message on the State of the Nation, Questions, Motions, and comments. I want to draw his attention to Standing Order 71(1), which states:

“Every Friday, the chairperson of the Business Committee shall present to the House, a statement on the business arranged for the following week.”

On Friday, there is nothing on the Business Statement on that day. Standing Order 71(1) mentions specifically Friday, but we cannot find it in the Statement. Even if it is not on Friday, Standing Order 71(2) says:

“Where the first Sitting of a Meeting precedes a Friday, the statement on the business arranged for the remainder of the week, where possible, shall be presented on the day of the commencement of the Meeting.”

So, Mr Speaker, this is just for the Majority Leader and Chairperson of the Business Committee to take note of.

Mr Speaker, last Friday, I raised the issue for the arrangement of the Minister for Finance, the Minister for Food and Agriculture, and the CEO of COCOBOD, so that Hon Members will be briefed on the policy announcement by the Minister. But he indicated that he will make that arrangement for the Ministers to appear. The week is ending today, but we have not heard anything from the Minister with regard to his briefing to the House on cocoa prices.

Yesterday, there was a demonstration in the country with regard to the same thing. Also, this morning, I chanced upon a Statement from the Catholic Bishops’ Conference, calling on the Government to look at the price. So, I do not know why the Majority Leader gave his word that the Minister was going to be arranged, but the Minister has not been arranged.

Mr Speaker, if the Majority Leader only answered question, but he does not want this matter to be addressed—The Majority Leader should give it a lot of attention. Farmers are going through a lot. Very soon, students will be dropping out of school because their fathers who are cocoa farmers cannot pay their school fees. People are cutting down their cocoa trees. Based on the assurances he gave us; we believed that he was going to arrange for the Minister to appear before the House. The Minister has not appeared before the House. Meanwhile people are suffering and are unhappy with what is happening. I urge him to arrange for the Minister to appear

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Habib Iddrisu, you are a senior Member. You know, on that matter, a Statement has been made within this week. Comments were taken on the Statement by the House. So, this cannot be a subject matter of comment on the Business Statement this same week.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, when I raised the matter, my request was that the Minister for Finance, the Minister for Food and Agriculture and the CEO of COCOBOD —the Majority Leader gave his word that he would try to convince the Minister to be present to address this matter. It has not been done and nothing has happened. I am just drawing his attention to why it did not happen and if it is still part of his plans to programme him —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: On that note, and with all due respect, you are out of order.

Hon Kingley Nyarko, you have the floor.

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, thanks for indulging me. Reading the Business Statement, I would want to pat the back of the Business Committee for the Statement. My issue has to do with the fact that we have a lot of Questions that are behind, we have not been able to ask and with referrals to Committees. But in this Statement, we are going to adjourn early on Thursday, even though we sit at 10:00 a.m. on Thursday. We are adjourning early also on Friday. My suggestion is that, if possible, on Wednesday, we can also sit early at

10:00 a.m. so that we can deal with a lot of the issues that are outstanding. Otherwise, if we start at 2:00 p.m., it is going to affect the progress of Business in the House. This is my humble submission to the Leader of the House.

Thank you.

Dr Tiah Abdul Kabiru Mahama: Mr Speaker, I join my Colleagues in commending the Business Committee for the Business schedules for the ensuing week. Mr Speaker, the first issue I would want to talk about is our Statements. Mr Speaker, I remember last week we discussed that extensively, but new formats have been proposed. I thought the conclusion we had last week was the effect that Hon Members should be limited to 15 minutes. Then irrespective of what we want to talk about, our time is limited to 15 minutes to make our presentation.

Mr Speaker, I see the new format font size 14 and double spacing to be a bit more problematic. A cursory demonstration would tell you that you will barely go beyond the introduction of your topic if you are going to use a font size of 14, double spacing, or 1.5 spacing, and basically, you cannot live within two pages with that particular prescription. So, I think that the Leader of the House would have to look at that. I agree completely that 15 minutes is more than enough, considering the fact that we have lots of Statements to be made and five minutes within the Standing Orders of the House to contribute to same is also important.

Mr Speaker, the next issue has to do with Questions. It appears there are backlog of Questions, from the last Session and this Session, directed to the Minister for Defence.

1:45 p.m.

I do appreciate the point that we do not have a substantive Minister for Defence, but the caretaker Minister, who is the Minister for Finance, should be up and doing in coming to this House to answer Questions. The Deputy can equally come. I have filed a couple of Questions, and I believe in the fullness of time they would be processed. But those matters are supposed to be issues of national security. They border on the safety of our compatriots.

So, Mr Speaker, I would appeal to the Leader of the House to consider, even how to prioritise the Ministers in their coming. If there are burning issues that require a certain Minister to change his schedules and come, I am sure you would be amenable to that and give it the needed attention.

Mr Speaker, with these few words, let me also commend the Chairperson and the Members of the Business Committee for doing a great job.

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: But per the *Order Paper*, is there a Question for the Minister for Defence to come and answer?

Dr A. K. T. Mahama: Mr Speaker, my understanding of the Business Statement is that there are activities supposed to be done in the ensuing week, and we are expected to comment on same. If I find any omission of an important matter that I believe ought to have been captured, I would draw the attention of the House to same. And I am drawing the attention of the House to the fact that—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Let me put it this way. In the Business Statement, is there a programme for the Minister for Finance which he did not attend for you to use the expression “He should be up and doing”?

Dr A. K. T. Mahama: Mr Speaker, I am saying that the Minister for Finance is the caretaker-Minister for Defence. I am using that in the context of he having oversight of the Ministry of Defence, not as Minister for Finance. So, what I am saying is that even though I know he has a role to play as Minister for Finance, when it comes to the role he has to play in the defence of the country, I expect that he should be up and doing. That is the comment I am making, not in respect of his role as Minister for Finance, so to speak.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Vincent Ekow Assafuah?

Mr Vincent Ekow Assafuah: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, I have an issue with respect to how Statements are being taken in this House. Mr Speaker, this is

the *Order Paper* for yesterday. The arrangement has been that I was supposed to be the third person to read a Statement. This is also the *Order Paper* for today, Friday 20th February, 2026. Here, I have been scheduled to be the fourth person to read a Statement.

Mr Speaker, this particular Statement in my name, has been advertised on the *Order Paper* for more than five months, five good months. It stemmed from last Session, and there has been a number of Statements that have been read in this House without recourse to Statements that are advertised in the *Order Paper* or on the console. As we speak, a Statement that has been advertised to be read before my Statement is not commemorative. As to how a Statement that can be read at any other time has been advertised before a Statement that I have submitted to this House to be read five months ago, I do not understand. Mr Speaker, it is problematic. I think that I need your indulgence to be able to support the Business Committee to assist us in that regard.

Secondly, Mr Speaker, about 30 or 40 per cent of Members in this House are not able to work from our offices. Our air conditioners are not working. We cannot receive visitors. We have complained over and over again. And we cannot work. It has been more than eight months.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, Hon Assafuah, what would you want the Business Committee to do? Because we are now taking the Business Statement.

Mr Assafuah: We are masters of our own rules—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I agree with what you are saying—

Mr Assafuah: Mr Speaker, I am pleading—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: But at the end of the day, the Business Committee is different from the House Committee, and you know that.

Mr Assafuah: Mr Speaker, may you allow, respectfully, today is Friday.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Is there anything in the rules that says that?

Mr Assafuah: The uncomfortability of Members of Parliament here is an eyesore—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, we take your first point. But on this point, you know the right thing to do.

Mr Assafuah: Mr Speaker, I agree—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: And on the first point, I admit Questions and Statements. I want to bring it to the floor of the House, that part of the problem is Leadership of the House.

Hon Members, throughout this week, we have taken Statements that were not programmed on the *Order Paper*. We have taken Statements that were not admitted and transmitted to the Clerk to Parliament to be programmed. We have taken Statements that were not routed

through the Whips. This problem will be resolved when we all begin to do the right thing. I had the cause to complain to the Whips that Members should be reoriented about the fact that you cannot send a Statement for admission unless it is recommended by the Whips. That is the practice I came to meet in this House. When Statements are channelled through the Whips, then they have responsibility of bringing the Members together that, if four or five of you are making Statements on same subject matter, let one person be the maker of the Statement and the rest reduce theirs to comments.

But if it is not happening that way, it means everybody would bring Statements on same subject matter. Then the person who is to admit the Statement will now tend to be doing the work of the Whips. So, if you stop prioritising some Statements over others, I believe this issue would be resolved, and we will go by Statements as programmed on the *Order Paper*. Everybody will have their turn to make their Statement.

Yes, Hon Nitiwul?

Mr Dominic Bingab Aduna Nitiwul:
Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, on the Business Statement, I see that the Leader of the House has stated that Ministers of State may be permitted to make Statements on government policy and that you would also admit Statements. But I am looking at the Ministers of State who would be allowed to make Statements.

I think that, Mr Speaker, you admitted a Statement yesterday on the effect of the terrorist attacks that led to about eight of our people losing their lives in Burkina Faso. Next week, out of interest in that matter, especially, as was generated in this House, the discussions that ensued and the conclusions as well as the interest of Ghanaians in this particular matter, I want to find out from the Hon Majority Leader whether he is scheduling the Minister for Foreign Affairs who, I have been told authoritatively that, is now going to Burkina Faso for two days to liaise with the people there, and then the Acting Minister for Defence, to brief Parliament extensively on what has happened, what they have done so far, especially with—We are aware of the fact that the three survivors are in Ghana and being treated at the 37 Military Hospital. But what has happened to the deceased? Are they repatriating their bodies to Ghana to their families? How are things going to be done?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Nitiwul, you know definitely that you are violating the rules. Do not reduce the time for commenting on the Business Statement to making Statements—

Mr Nitiwul: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

I am taking the comments out—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: You know definitely you are not in charge of Government Business. So, leave the Government Business to the Leader of Government Business—

Mr Nitiwul: I hear you, Mr Speaker. But I want to hear from him—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, you know what you are doing is not proper. I said you know because you are a former Leader of this House.

Mr Nitiwul: Mr Speaker, I want to hear from him about it—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Kojo Oppong Nkrumah?

Mr Kojo Oppong Nkrumah: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, on the item numbered 3, the Leader of Government Business has mentioned that His Excellency the President will address the House. And he went further to admonish Members to be seated by 9:30 a.m. so that we are able to participate fully. That brings to mind also the issue of our guests who come to join us for these events. Very often, it is the high class in society: military, diplomatic corps, *et cetera*.

1:55 p.m.

I want to enquire from the Leader of Government Business whether, as has been done in the past, we are planning to bring in some of the critical parts of our society, like cocoa farmers. We will recall that the last time President Mahama was in power, Amina, the lady who was doing, I think, pork or something, was brought into the Public Gallery. I am wondering whether there are plans to bring cocoa farmers, *et cetera*. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Kojo Oppong Nkrumah, you are no longer a Minister in this Government. So, you do not have control of who should be invited or who should not be invited.

Hon Minority Chief Whip?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, let me thank the Majority Leader. I see a great deal of effort for us to get clinical on businesses to be prosecuted. I intend to limit myself to the content of the Business Statement. I think on page one, where we have the Minister for Works and Housing scheduled to answer a number of questions.

Mr Speaker, the Majority Leader could not attend the Business Committee meeting. We had agreed that to the extent that the Minister for Works and Housing has questions to answer within the week, then he should be accordingly programmed to come and apprise us on measures being put in place to deal with flooding. Because the rains are here. That call was made and it is conspicuously missing. We want to remind the Leader of Government Business. So, the Minister for Works and Housing should be finding his way here because he has business to prosecute on a scheduled day so he should also be scheduled accordingly because it is a subject matter that comes under his purview. That would be my first observation.

Mr Speaker, I also see the Chairperson of the Business Committee providing a framework in which we should navigate how to deal with Statements and I

commend him for that. This is Parliament and like any other Parliament in other jurisdictions do, we should be gravitating towards how we can get clinical and get efficient in the presentation of Statements.

So, a framework has been given by the Majority Leader, but he has copiously referenced Order 93. But Order 92(1) is also an avenue for Hon Ministers to make Statements on policy. So, the begging concern is would this framework apply in terms of limitation, font size and all that? Or would same apply to Ministers who will come under Order 93(2) to make policy Statements? It is a concern we should be looking at, Majority Leader.

Now, Hon Colleagues have already averted their minds to the preponderance of Statements that are advertised on the *Order Paper* and are not taken. Yes, I admit that is the process. Statements are admitted by the Speaker. It goes through the Motion and they are advertised on the *Order Paper*. Where they remain for a long time on the *Order Paper* and are not taken—Mr Speaker, Statement to be admitted is in your bosom but once it is programmed—as of the last count, we had 19 Statements advertised on the *Order Paper*. So, we have to find a way to navigate it. Those that are ready to be taken, maybe first 10 or first five are advertised but when we advertise as many as 19, we give false hope to others. Then they will have a reasonable ground to speak to why their Statement—I saw two of Hon Edem Agbana's Statements advertised but were not taken. He has grounds to raise the issue as a concern.

Mr Speaker, on the referrals, I know the Majority Leader is a bit frustrated on that but we all need to help him. Mr Speaker, I do not want to sound repetitive but on page two, the Majority Leader is basically appealing to Committee leadership to work on referrals that have been programmed. But that is at variance with the earlier communication.

Mr Speaker, if you may recall, earlier communication had been that Committee heads would come under some punitive measures. Now we have 294 referrals pending. Historic. It has never happened. I am not too old in this House, but I know this is historic. We have 294 referrals and they have not been worked on? Under 24-Hour economy? It is worrying. So now the Majority Leader is appealing to them. Earlier, the Leader had said that one will suffer punitive measures. What has happened to the call for punitive measures to be meted out to Committee leaders who are not working on their referrals? That is another question.

Then on the flip side of the coin, there are Committee leaders who have also worked. Their Reports are ready but they are not being taken. The Pension Scheme, housekeeping report among others are all programmed by the *Order Paper*. We are not taking them. How clinical can we get? That is worrying.

Mr Speaker, again, with the Committee of the Whole, I have seen there is a programme for joint Caucus. I am sure we are referring to the Committee of the Whole. We should be informing the Minister who is supposed

to appear at the Committee of the Whole, not just the notification but specific notification on the matters that should be discussed. They should come prepared. I am aware the Hon Minister for Finance is supposed to be scheduled at the Committee of the Whole, our Friend. It is not for nothing that one of our own is the Minister for Finance. He should be told.

Also, the Majority Leader's back is weak. The morale is weak. The morale of the Backbench is weak. There is no morale. Very soon, they will leave him alone. *[Laughter]* He will sit in the Black Seat alone. So, the specific notification of the Hon Minister for Finance on the Committee of the Whole meeting on Wednesday, on subject matter specific should be told. He should not come and say that he is coming back. This is the House of Parliament.

Mr Speaker, District Assemblies Common Fund (DACF) is not statutory but constitutional. When is the Administrator coming? The morale of the Assemblies is weak. *[Interruption]* So, the Administrator for DACF should be programmed for next week. We will not take any excuse. We are operating under a 24-Hour economy. We have passed the Bill to an Act.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Chief Whip, some matters that you have raised for a Committee of the Whole, should it be a joint Caucus or you still maintain it should be a Committee of the Whole? Because this matter has been clarified.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I can refer to Order 261. With your leave, Order 261 among others with the most important part being (f): "any other matter referred by the House" could be dealt with by the Committee of the Whole. But I am not referring to the Committee of the Whole.

2:05 p.m.

I am referring to what has been stated in the Business Statement as the joint Caucus. I know there has been engagement, and the joint Caucus is supposed to address a matter we have agreed on. That is what I am speaking to.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: If you are the Caucus Leaders, and something has to be done by the joint Caucus, relate it to what is happening now, as we comment on the Business Statement.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I am guided, but I will proceed. I am only rehashing the point that next week we should deal with the District Assemblies Common Fund (DACF). The delay is becoming harmful. The Ghana Education Trust Fund (GETFund) is also a concern. We have not dealt with that formula. We have a mandate to deal with these matters. And I would want to plead with the Leader of Government Business to programme these matters to be dealt with as soon as possible.

Finally, I see 34 Questions programmed for next week. Only 34 Questions out of the backlog of over 300 Questions. Why? Now, the cycle in this House is that when the Message on the

State of the Nation is presented on Friday, we have, to all intents and purposes, about two weeks to debate. We have barely five weeks to go before recess. The question is: what is the plan to dispose of these almost 300 Questions?

In this House, we have been doing about 70 to 75 Questions weekly. Why are we doing 34? Under the 24-Hour Economy, 34 Questions is totally unacceptable.

Mr Speaker, there is a matter I want to raise. I would want to look into the eyes of our respected Leader and say that the convention and practice at the Business Committee have been that, when Questions are admitted by Mr Speaker, they are ferried to the Table Office. It goes through the motion, and then these Questions are advertised on the *Order Paper*. We have been told that when the Questions are advertised on the Business Statement, and the Business Statement is adopted by this House, the Table Office would have to communicate the same to the sector Ministers involved.

Now, we are told that they have to wait for the availability of the Ministers. That is unacceptable. We have to programme the Ministers, and when the Ministers cannot appear, they should write formally to this House. And that is what is giving rise to the situation we have now, where we have close to 300 Questions that are lagging. They have not been answered. Some of them are no longer useful, and Members are worried. Statements have been advertised on the *Order Papers*. They cannot make the

Statement. They cannot ask their Questions. Why? This is the Parliament of Ghana; our oversight cannot be undermined.

I insist that, henceforth, when the Questions go through the process, and the Business Statement is adopted, the same must be communicated to the Ministers. When the Ministers cannot attend, they must formally write to Parliament. We cannot be treating the Minister with kid gloves. As and when they are available, they will come; when they are not, they will not. It is worrying. I am very worried.

I am very emotional today because a trend is emerging. Last Sitting, we received over 20 letters for one reason or another. Either they cannot come, or they are attending conferences elsewhere. What is that? This is Parliament. We will not be taken for granted. So, we are going to look at them with an eagle eye. He should have his Ministers available. At least the Minister for Roads and Highways is always here. Why is it that the Minister for Roads and Highways always respects this House and comes to answer Questions? The other Ministers should take a cue. They sit in the comfort of their offices and only write letters to state that they either cannot come or are attending conferences. Enough is enough. They should take Parliament seriously.

I thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Kwame Agbodza.

Mr Kwame Governs Agbodza: Mr Speaker, the passion with which my very good Friend is speaking, I am wondering if he is campaigning for a certain position [*Laughter*]. This looks like a kind of campaign. It is not very usual of him. I am suspicious, but let me leave that one there.

Mr Speaker, it cannot be that this is the highest ever referral that is yet to be treated in the House. I agree with my Colleague that when we have so many referrals to Committees, and they are not treated or taken, it makes us ineffective. So, I agree that Committee leaders should do well. I also noticed that the time for the Statement is regularly one hour, although the Standing Orders say that the Speaker can extend it.

But if the Business Committee lists 10 Statements, obviously, we are not being realistic because we are not going to be able to take 10 Statements when everybody is speaking, even for five minutes. It will take us more than five hours to be able to deal with those things. So, maybe the Business Committee should be firm as to whether we need to programme a certain number of Statements only.

Mr Speaker, it is also not very accurate that Colleague Ministers are asked Questions and they only write to say that they cannot be here. On Wednesday, I was here when a Colleague asked a Question. I spent time with my agencies to prepare Answers. When the Question was called, the Colleague was not here. What about that one? So, it works both ways. Yes, I am talking about my

Colleague, Hon Asenso-Boakye, who wanted some clarification on the Accra-Kumasi Expressway. I prepared an Answer only to find out that my Colleague was not even in the Chamber. What about that one? So, while it is important to insist that Ministers are here to answer Questions, those who ask the Question must also be here when Ministers are here.

Mr Speaker, the Minister for Finance is very diligent. He will always be here. The whole of this week, he has been working hard to pay an interest of GH¢10 billion on the mess created before President Mahama took office. Would it be more important for him to be in this House to answer Questions? If Ghanaians were asked, “should the Minister for Finance remain in this House answering Questions, or go and find the money and pay the 10 billion?” I know Ghanaians will say that he should go and find the money to pay the 10 billion. So, he was actually working for Ghana. He was not sitting in the office doing nothing. He did what was important.

So, Mr Speaker, I think we should put these things in context. But my good friend said that 75 Questions have been answered in a week. Maybe if he can help the House and tell us which week the 75 Questions were answered. All right; I will leave it like that.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Leader.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, thank you very much.

Mr Speaker, it is true that earlier in the week, Hon Habib Iddrisu approached me, and I think he raised it, that there was a need to invite to the House, the Ministers of Finance, Food and Agriculture and relevant agency heads to have a discussion on cocoa. I committed to doing that. Somehow, the following day, when the Minority Leader arrived, he insisted on making a Statement on the cocoa crisis. Again, I urged them to wait so I could invite the two critical sector Ministers to the Chamber for a comprehensive debate on the issue and to take their reports. But they insisted on making the Statement on that day.

I indicated that if they insist on making a Statement for us to discuss, I will see no need for the Minister for Finance or the Minister for Food and Agriculture to come back here again. So, we allowed them. They made a Statement and I then insisted that the Minister for Finance hold a press conference at which he read to the rest of the nation. So, I was using the opportunity to repeat entirely what the Minister for Finance had said at that press conference because it addressed all the issues that they had raised in their Statement.

2:15 p.m.

So, Mr Speaker, I remain convinced that, in the circumstances, unless there are any new developments and the Hon Minister for Finance feels he should come and brief this House, every other issue has been exhaustively discussed. Even though we have committed ourselves to running a 24-Hour Economy, we have also committed

ourselves to managing our time efficiently, so that we do not discuss the same thing 10 times.

Mr Speaker, just because they think that cocoa politics is what can help their party—I can assure them that we know whom the demonstrators are, and we know their real motivation for demonstrating. We know that genuine cocoa farmers know that there is a world crisis, and that would definitely affect their bottom line, which is the income that they will earn from the cocoa sector. So, you cannot give what they do not have, even if you promised it. What they are proposing is what they did, and they collapsed the economy of Ghana. They put the Ghana Cocoa Board (COCOBOD) in debt with over GHC 326 billion. All of that was the money of the cocoa farmers. So, we would not pander to those sentiments. The practical problem is there. The farmer appreciates it, and I can assure them that the farmer appreciates the solution proposed by the Government.

Mr Speaker, on the issue of Statements, I think that we should copy what pertains in other jurisdictions where we make very brief Statements. Even at Conclave, we were discussing this. Yesterday, we spent over an hour in this House debating whether to take a Statement or not. The first Statement which the Speaker rejected, was six pages long. When we make a six-page Statement, and some of them are in very fine print, we spend all our time on one Statement, and there will be a backlog of Statements. So, unless we accept—even the 15 minutes the Standing Orders

provide for, I think it is excessive. I have seen in other jurisdictions where, in a day, they take 20 or 30 Statements. So, for instance, an event or incident occurs in the constituency of a Member of Parliament, and they want to have it placed on record. So, all they come to say is that in their constituency, there was an accident with five fatalities and three injuries.

The accident was a result of X, Y, and Z, and the police are investigating it. Therefore, they want to urge the road traffic authorities and others to take action. The Member is done and the Statement has been made. What happened in the constituency has been recorded. One or two people can make some very brief comments. Then the next person can also make a Statement. But we see people come with thesis instead of Statements, and they go on with a presentation of some background and *et cetera*. Who says we do not know the background?

Mr Speaker, we should just come and make a pointed Statement about what affects our constituencies so that it is on record that as a Member of Parliament, you have made a Statement about the incident. Then the media will cover it and your constituents will see it.

Mr Speaker, on the issue of jumping the queue, they are the main architects of jumping the queue. In the last week, every single day that they have come to this Chamber, they have lobbied for us to jump the queue so that they will make some Statement that they think is politically convenient. Then they turn

around to blame the rest of us for allowing people to jump the queue. Even yesterday, they forced us. When we started the day with a commitment that we are taking the two advertised Statements, the Speaker repeated it several times, and when they came, they thought that the Burkina Faso incident was more politically convenient. They made us sidestep our commitments, and we granted them the space to make a Statement on the Burkina Faso incident. Now that they have fallen there, they have come to take me on that I have allowed people to sidestep the Statements advertised. I thank them very much. We will see if they will be able to get any of their Statements made on this Floor going forward. Unless it is advertised, we will not allow it to be taken on this Floor. *[Laughter]* I think that is what they want us to do, and I will start doing that.

Mr Speaker, on the issue of inviting cocoa farmers, there are many cocoa farmers sitting in this Chamber. There are a lot of people sitting here who are sons and daughters of cocoa farmers. So, cocoa farmers are part of us; they are always here. Many of the dignitaries that we see sitting here, have cocoa farm. So, do not imagine that cocoa farmers are a different category. When the cocoa prices go down, I can assure them that many Members of Parliament sitting on this Side and Ministers are also going to lose income. The impression should not be created that it is only the ordinary person sitting out there in the village who would lose income. Everybody loses income as a result of this global crisis that has confronted us.

Mr Speaker, I think the issue of air conditioners and *et cetera* has been discussed extensively at the Board, and processes are in place to procure the replacement of the air conditioning system. Indeed, we toyed with a temporary arrangement because we have seen that some Members of Parliament have also procured fans that have air conditioning installed in them. At the Board level, a decision was taken that the Office of the Clerk should consider identifying the offices that have problems and then buy the fans for them to use in the interim, while we wait for recess by which time we would have finished the procurement process. During Recess they can install the new air conditioning facility in the building. But the process is underway to deal with the issue of the air conditioners.

Mr Speaker, on the backlog of Questions, if we deal with even how Questions are asked, what Questions to ask, and which Questions must be oral, I think that it is important for us to revise the practice of automatically admitting Questions as oral because the MP has indicated that he wants it to be oral. Some of the time, they are just seeking information, and that information can just be communicated to them by a written Answer, which can be advertised and then published in the *Order Paper* so that they can have access to the information. But if we insist that with every Question, the Minister must come and stand here and answer them, we are going to create a problem for all of us. I can assure them that no matter what they do, President John Dramani

Mahama will not increase the number of Ministers. [*Hear! Hear!*]

We will not increase the number of Ministers. If they think that by inundating Ministers with Questions, they will be forced to increase the number of Ministers, so that we will fail on our political promise, we will not do that. We will not increase the number of Ministers, and at the same time, those Ministers must also perform their job, just as he has indicated.

Mr Speaker, they left us huge debts. The Minister for Finance had to pay by the deadline the day before yesterday, GH¢10 billion. How is he going to pay if all the time they come here and ask him Questions that do not help him to raise GH¢10 billion?

So, Mr Speaker, the Ministers have to carry out their core responsibility of administering this country, and at the same time, come to this Parliament and answer Questions. The Ministers have been coming.

2:24 p.m.

They should not create the impression that they do not come. As we speak, the Questions that we have scheduled for today, the Hon Minister was here. He sent his Deputy Minister to come and answer the Questions. Sometimes the Ministers come to answer Question and then we spend the whole time engaging in politics and consuming their time. Hon Annoh-Dompreh spoke and spoke. Now that I am speaking, he is sitting there, gesturing and making all sort of

mannerisms that I am not speaking to the Business Statement. Was he speaking to the Business Statement? I am asking, was he speaking to the Business Statement?

Mr Speaker, I am saying that we will not increase the number of Ministers and the available Ministers will come and answer the Questions as and when time permits. Mr Speaker, I also—*[Laughter]*—I am not the President, but I can tell them that we will not increase the number of Ministers. The Ministers will remain 60.

Mr Speaker, let me thank Colleagues. Let us all try and then come next week for the Message on the State of the Nation and let us be punctual and come on time. I believe that after that, we will schedule the debate, but still make room for answering as many Questions as possible.

This week I believe the Business Committee had to decrease the number for next week because we have already agreed that on Thursday, we will not Sit for long because we will have to adjourn early for them to have access to the Chamber. So, we do not have Thursday. Then on Friday too, we will not be able to ask Questions because the President is coming here to deliver the State of the Nation address. Effectively, next week, we have only Tuesday and Wednesday. For Tuesday and Wednesday, we have scheduled 34 Questions. So 34 Questions for two days is reasonable. If we use two days to answer 34 Question, if we had four days how, many would we answer? We would answer close to the 70

Questions that they say should be our target.

So we are only being reasonable that we do not have Thursday and Friday, so that is how we have reduced the number of Questions. That is how come it has reduced to 34. Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: I think before we adopt the Business Statement, just to remind the Hon Leader—*[Interruption]*—No, I am satisfied. Just to bring a point to the Hon Leader's notification. I mean he is his usual self. He blows hot and cold. It is fine.

Mr Speaker, but just to remind him on the framework for the Business Statement. I agree with him on the Statement following best practices. I want to know when they are coming out of Standing Order 91(2), if the same framework were applied to them. That is the point I want to emphasise on.

Mr Ayariga: That is not the matter we have discussed at the Business Committee. So I cannot come and impose my own ideas. I convey what we discussed at Business Committee. We did not discuss at the Business Committee.—When we discuss at Business Committee and think that for Ministerial Statements, there should be a framework, we will come and announce it. But we have not discussed that.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the Business Statement as presented, is hereby adopted.

Hon Members, indulge me to acknowledge the presence of students from Asiamah Memorial School led by Mr Albert Nyarko, Head Teacher. They are from Okaikwei North Constituency. They numbered 20.

We also have students from Aduman Senior High School, led by Mr Christopher Namsakiya Anaba. They are from Afigya Kwabre South. They numbered 51.

We have Legacy Girls College, led by Mr Stephen Tetteh, a teacher. They are from Lower Manya, Krobo. They numbered 133.

We also have Star Achievers School, led by Mr Patrick Dodzi Aguti, Head Teacher. They are from Domeabra Obom. They numbered 32.

[Pupils from Asiamah Memorial School were acknowledged]

[Students from Aduman Senior High School were acknowledged]

[Student from Legacy Girls College were acknowledged]

[Pupils from Star Achievers School were acknowledged]

Hon Members, I welcome them on your behalf and urge them to have a fruitful visit to Parliament. Thank you for coming.

Yes, Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: The Speaker will take the Questions. The Minister for Energy

and Green Transition is attending a function with H. E. the President in Tema and has asked his Deputy, with your kind permission, who is well briefed, to come and answer the Questions on his behalf. If he gets here at one point and needs to support, he will support.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, this is what we have always been expecting. When the Sector Minister cannot make it, the Deputy Minister should be here, so we are not opposed. The Minister is a good Friend. He is one of our own.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Deputy Minister, you may take the designated seat while I call on Mr William Ntebe, Hon Member of Parliament of Tatale-Sanguli to pose the Question numbered 307.

ORAL ANSWERS TO QUESTIONS

MINISTRY OF ENERGY AND GREEN TRANSITION

Update on cost-sharing electrification projects in Unibado, Nachambu, Naloo, Sbonjida and Tikassarini

Mr Ntebe Ayo William (NDC — Tatale-Sanguli): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition to provide an update on the cost-sharing electrification projects in the following communities: (i) Unibado (ii) Nachambu (iii) Naloo (iv) Sabonjida (v) Tikassarini.

Deputy Minister for Energy (Richard Gyan-Mensah)(MP): Mr

Speaker, The communities of Nachamba A, Nachamba B, Nachamba C, Sabonjida A, Sabonjida B, and Tikassarini form part of the Ministry's ongoing Cost Sharing Projects in the Tatale-Sanguli District of the Northern Region. A total of 152 High Voltage (HV) poles required for these communities have been supplied and planted. Conductor stringing has been completed at Nachamba A, Sabonjida A, and Tikarsani.

Additionally, a total of 237 Low Voltage (LV) poles have been supplied to the communities. Most of the pole-top accessories have been delivered and conductor stringing has been completed at Nachamba A, Sabonjida A, and Tikassarini.

Installation works, including customer service connections, have been completed at Nachamba A, Sabonjida A and Tikassarini. However, works are still ongoing at Nachamba B, Nachamba C, and Sabonjida B.

Unibado and Naloo communities were not part of the original award under the Cost Sharing Project. However, some of the materials were extended to these communities to support the expansion of the electrification projects. Both HV and LV works have been completed and the communities are currently awaiting the installation of transformers.

The Ministry is implementing a local turnkey project earmarked at completing all ongoing and some new electrification projects in the Northern, Savannah and Upper West regions this year for which

all the above-mentioned communities form part. This initiative is to eliminate delays associated with the traditional SHEP projects.

Thank you.

[Published by order of Mr Speaker]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I would call on Prof Titus Kofi Beyuo, MP for Lambussie to ask his Question.

Mr Anthony Mwinkaara Sumah: Thank you. Mr Speaker, I have the authority to —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Are you Titus Beyuo?

Mr Sumah: No, please.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Please resume your sit.

I call on Prof Titus Beyuo to ask the Question numbered 308. Is Titus Beyuo in the House? You have the authority of Prof Titus Beyuo? Very well.

Completion of Abandoned Electrification Projects in Kuntawii Suke No. 1, Nicheli, Larni Karesele and Kelegan

Mr Anthony Mwinkaara Sumah on behalf of Prof Titus Kofi Beyuo (NDC — Lambussie): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition when the abandoned electrification projects in the following

communities will be completed: (i) Kuntawii (ii) Suke number one (1) (iii) Nicheli (iv) Karni Karesele (v) Kelegan.

Deputy Minister for Energy (Richard Gyan-Mensah)(MP): Mr Speaker, the communities namely, Kuntawii, Suke Number one, Nicheli and Karni Karesele form part of the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition's ongoing SHEP-4 and SHEP-5 Rural Electrification Projects in the Lambussie/Karni District of the Upper West Region.

Installation works including High Voltage (HV), Low Voltage (LV) and Transformer Substation works have been completed at Kuntawii and Suke Number One. However, 2km out of 4km completed HV line serving Nicheli has been vandalised. The 33/0.433kV, 200kVA 3-ph. transformer serving Nicheli has been mounted and yet to be dressed. 53no. LV poles out of 150no. LV poles have been supplied, planted and strung.

At Karni Karesele, 10 out of 20no. HV poles have been planted and strung. The 33/0.433kV, 100kVA 3-ph. transformer serving Karni Karesele has been mounted and yet to be dressed. LV poles are yet to be supplied.

The Ministry is implementing a local turnkey project earmarked at completing all ongoing electrification projects in the Northern, Savannah and Upper West Regions this year for which all the above-mentioned communities form part.

2:35 p.m.

This initiative is to eliminate delays associated with the traditional SHEP projects. The Kilagan community does not form part of any of the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition's ongoing projects. This community would be considered for electrification when there is sufficient balance on funding under the above-mentioned projects.

The First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Member, any supplementary question?

Mr Sumah: Thank you, Mr Speaker. The Hon Member, on whose behalf I asked the Question is satisfied with the response.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, my apologies. The Hon Member, Prof Titus Beyuo was sitting at the middle here, so I saw the Hon Member there and I thought Prof Beyuo was seated while you wanted to ask a Question.

Hon Members, this is a Constituency specific Question. We move to the Question numbered 366, standing in the name of Mr Nelson Kofi Djabab, Krachi East. Yes, Hon Member?

Mr Eric Edem Agbana: Mr Speaker, I have the authority of the Mr Nelson Djabab to ask a Question on his behalf.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: When I sit down and I watch certain things, I wonder if Members really have the authority. Because he could not instruct or give authority to more than one

person. *[Laughter]* So, I do not expect to see more than one Member, standing to ask the Question in the absence of the Hon Member.

Mr Agbana: Mr Speaker, he called me a couple of minutes ago and I have the message here.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Please proceed to ask the Question.

Plans to Connect some Island Communities to the National Grid

Mr Eric Edem Agbana (NDC — Ketu North) on behalf of Mr Nelson Kofi Djabab (NDC — Krachi East): Mr Speaker, I rise to ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition the plans of the Ministry to connect the following island communities to the national grid of electricity: (i) Beposu (ii) Nyarkornakpoe (iii) Atsivikope (iv) Tumikope (v) Sikape (vi) Jerusalem.

Mr Gyan-Mensah: The Ministry wishes to state that Sikape, Jerusalem and Kpogede communities have already been considered under the implementation of the ongoing Mini-Grid electrification contract with grant funding from the African Development Bank, which is expected to be completed by the end of 2026. Atsivikope, Beposu and Nyarkormakope have been earmarked for mini grid electrification under the next phase of the implementation of the Mini-Grid Programme, in accordance with the National Electrification Scheme.

The specific timing for electrifying these communities is subject to ongoing efforts to unlock additional funds for electrification and the House will be duly updated on the outcome of these efforts.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, any supplementary question?

Mr Agbana: Mr Speaker, no supplementary question.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much.

This is also Constituency specific Question. We move to the Question numbered 652, standing in the name of Mr Ebenezer Alumire Ndebilla, Member of Parliament for Zebilla.

Completion of Stalled Rural Electrification in Zebilla

Mr Ebenezer Alumire Ndebilla (NDC — Zebilla): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

I rise to ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition when stalled rural electrification projects in the Zebilla Constituency will be completed.

Mr Gyan-Mensah: Thank you.

The Ministry is undertaking electrification works in 53 communities in the Bawku West District. A total of 703 out of 768 HV poles have been supplied, planted and partly strung in these communities. Out of the 8,530 LV poles required, 2,586 have been supplied, planted and partly strung in these communities.

The delays in the execution of the electrification projects are as a result of shortage of some key materials/equipment including LV poles, transformers, conductors, meters etc. The Ministry is procuring these materials and equipment and will arrange for the release of same to allow for completion of the electrification projects in the district.

The Ministry of Energy and Green Transition expects to complete the installation works at Guzongo/Salipiiga, Wiiga/Gunga, Ziki Asobilla, Dangunga Ziboko, Dangunga Basic School, Dangunga Gbango, Kansongo, Sakpare, Timpeligo Yipala, Bugore, Gozesi and Sitande communities by the end of December 2026.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any supplementary question?

Mr Ndebilla: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker. I think the Hon Minister has given an elaborate explanation. I am satisfied with the Answer.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you. The Question numbered 390, standing in the name of Mr Michael Kwasi Aidoo, Member of Parliament for Oforikrom. You have the floor.

Prof Kingsley Nyarko: Mr Speaker, why are you shaking your head—
[Laughter]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Do you want me to say why?

Prof K. Nyarko: No, do not say why.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I should not? You asked a question I want to give you an answer.

Prof K. Nyarko: No, please, do not answer. Mr Speaker, I am just craving your indulgence to permit me to ask—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Please do.

Berthing of MT Marlin Ametrine Outside Revised Laycan Schedule

Prof Kingsley Nyarko (NPP — Kwadaso) on behalf of Mr Michael Kwasi Aidoo (NPP — Oforikrom): I rise to ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition how the attempted berthing of MT Marlin Ametrine outside the revised laycan schedule occurred and what measures are being taken to prevent such regulatory lapses and future disruptions.

Mr Gyan-Mensah: The Ministry of Energy and Green Transition has set up a Laycan Advisory Committee with industry representation that plays a supervisory role in the management of the Laycan Programme to avert disruptions to the programme. The NPA has, since fourth quarter (Q4) of 2025 implemented new criteria for allocation of laycans to Bulk Oil Import, Distribution and Export Companies (BIDECs), the co-loaded approach which has ensured a more equitable allocation of laycans to BIDECs and also dedicated laycans for strategic supplies and the power sector.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, any supplementary question?

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, I would like to find out from the Minister, regarding the work of the advisory committee on the nature of the supervisory role and how effective it has been. Thank you.

Mr Gyan-Mensah: The advisory committee actually has all the stakeholders, that is the BIDEC, the Ministry, NPA and even the oil marketing companies on there. So far, since they started working from the last quarter of 2025, their activities and their reports show that there has not been any issue with their operations.

So, we deem it that they are doing so well since no complaints have come up since they started working.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, any further supplementary question?

Prof K. Nyarko: I think we are all right with the responses.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

We would now give the floor to Mr Stanley Yaw Nandaya, Member of Parliament for Wulensi, to ask Question numbered 671. Hon Member, you have the floor. *[Pause]* Hon Members, in the same vein, I would ask that the Answer be transmitted and published.

Extension of Electricity to Some Communities in Wulensi

Mr Stanley Yaw Nandaya (IND — Wulensi): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Energy and Green

Transition the plans of the Ministry to extend electricity to the remaining sixty-two communities in the Wulensi COnstituency and the plans to Ministry has to connect the following communities, which have been wired since 2017, to the national grid: (i) Sakpe (ii) Gonguni (iii) Bangniyili

Mr Gyan-Mensah: Mr Speaker, the Sakpe, Gonguni and Bangniyili communities form part of the Ministry's ongoing SHEP Project in the Nanumba North District of the Northern Region. A total of 258 High Voltage (HV) poles required for these communities have been supplied and planted. Most of the pole-top accessories have been provided, and conductor stringing has been completed in the above-mentioned communities. Additionally, 370 Low Voltage (LV) poles required for the project have been supplied and installed in the communities. Most of the pole-top accessories have been provided, and conductor stringing has been completed in the above-mentioned communities. Transformers have been supplied to the communities but are yet to be installed.

The Ministry is implementing a local turnkey project earmarked at completing all ongoing electrification projects in the Northern, Savannah and Upper West regions this year for which all the above-mentioned communities form part. This initiative is to eliminate delays associated with the traditional SHEP projects. The remaining 62 communities will be considered when funding becomes available.

[Published by order of Mr Speaker]

We move to the question numbered 391, standing in the name of Alhaji Nurideen Muhammed Mumuni, Member of Parliament for Nalerigu/Gambaga.

2:45 p.m.

Yes, you have the floor.

Measures to solve Power Outage in Nalerigu/Gambaga Constituency

Alhaji Nurideen Muhammed Mumuni (Nalerigu/Gambaga): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition the specific measures the Ministry is taking to solve the persistent power outage in the Nalerigu/Gambaga Constituency.

Mr Gyan-Mensah: NEDCo is aware of the supply challenges in the Nalerigu/Gambaga Constituency. The current instability is primarily due to the security situation in Bawku and surrounding communities, alongside obsolete equipment at the Bawku Primary Substation. Due to high security risks, maintenance teams have been unable to perform routine maintenance at the substation or along the line route, and operational staff in the zone have been relocated for their safety.

To address these persistent outages, the following specific measures are being implemented:

Specialised Line Maintenance: NEDCo has scheduled special maintenance, including vegetation control and insulator replacements, with

the assistance of security forces, to reduce transient faults.

New Line Construction: With the support of the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition, a new 34.5kV line is being constructed to connect Gambaga to the Walewale network to improve the power situation in the Gambaga/Nalerigu corridor. Construction work on this new line is currently estimated at 80 per cent completion.

Grid Reinforcement: NEDCo is planning to replace obsolete equipment at the Bawku substation as soon as the security situation allows for safe technical intervention.

To further mitigate the challenge, the following interventions are being considered:

Short Term: NEDCo will enhance downstream protection within the network, taking into account the extensive feeder length. This will involve the installation of auto-reclosers to enable fault isolation and minimise widespread outages across the entire feeder. Implementation of this initiative is pending commitment authorisation from the Ministry of Finance before works can commence.

Medium Term: NEDCo will establish a switching station at Nalerigu to provide dedicated feeders to the Bunkpurugu, Gambaga, and Garu stations. The switching station will be supplied from the Zebilla Bulk Supply Point (BSP).

Long Term: NEDCo in conjunction with GRIDCo will construct a Bulk Supply Point (BSP) at Napanduri to serve Nalerigu, Gambaga, Bunkprugu, and surrounding communities.

Alhaji Mumuni: Mr Speaker, thank you very much. I am satisfied with the Answer.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you. We would move to the Question numbered 540 standing in the name of Hon Issah Salifu Taylor.

Connection to the National Grid

Mr Issah Salifu Taylor (NDC – Tarkwa/Nsuaem): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition when the following communities in the Tarkwa Nsuaem Constituencies will be connected to the national grid: (i) Ebussem (ii) Esuoso (iii) Nyamease (iv) Aklika (v) Krobofo (vi) Ekurase (vii) Kwesikrom (viii) Pataho Brenya (ix) Bepoekyir.

Mr Gyan-Mensah: The communities namely, Ebussem, Esuoso, Nyametease, Aklika, Krobofo, Ekurase, Kwesikrom, Pataho Brenya and Bepoekyir do not form part of any of the Ministry's ongoing Self-Help Electrification Programme (SHEP). However, the Ministry has tasked its consultant to undertake engineering survey in the communities to be considered for connection to the national electricity grid in the subsequent phases of the electrification programme when funds are available.

I would also want to take this opportunity to urge the Member of Parliament to also officially write and request that these communities are added so that we can add it to the ongoing considerations and expedite action on it. Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Member?

Mr Taylor: Mr Speaker, I think the Minister has to come in again because there is no timeline. It is just surprising that of course —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, ask a supplementary question.

Mr Taylor: Can the Minister indicate clearly the timelines for such a project?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Did you listen to the Answer of the Minister?

Mr Taylor: Mr Speaker, yes, I did.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: They are now going to do engineering work and the Minister indicated that as a Member of Parliament, you have not requested, so put in a request. So, you have not put in your request yet you want the Minister to give you a timeline.

Mr Taylor: Mr Speaker, I think he said they are going to do engineering work.

Mr Gyan-Mensah: I believe the Minister at the end of the day has even given good advice.

Mr Taylor: So, I just need the timelines for the engineering work, respectfully.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, when are you going to make a request?

Mr Taylor: I will make a request next week, but he needs to tell me when the engineering works are going to be started.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We move to the Question numbered 670 standing in the name of Hon Emmanuel Kofi Ntekuni, Member of Parliament for Pru West.

Electricity Connection in Pru West

Mr Emmanuel Kofi Ntekuni (NDC - Pru West): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition the plans of the Ministry to expand electricity connection in the following communities: (i) Prang, which happens to be my district capital, (ii) Abua (iii) Adjaraja – Beposo (iv) Fawoman

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Where did you get the district capital from in the Question?

Mr Ntekuni: Mr Speaker, it is not in the Question.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, what are you supposed to do? I called upon you to read the Question numbered 670. You do exactly the same. You do not add, you do not subtract.

Mr Ntekuni: Mr Speaker, I am guided. Thank you.

Mr Emmanuel K. Ntekuni (Pru West): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition the plans of the Ministry to expand electricity connection in the following communities: (i) Prang (ii) Abua (iii) Adjaraja – Beposo (iv) Fawoman (v) Dama-Nkwanta (vi) Abeasi (vii) Komfuorkrom (viii) Zabrama (ix) Yawpare (x) Benim (xi) Cherambo and Kamanpa.

Mr Gyan-Mensah: Mr Speaker, respectfully, I do not have the response to this Question because it was not part of the Questions that were transmitted to me.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. We will direct the Clerks-at-the-Table to transmit the Question for a response from the Minister. So kindly take note and transmit the Question to the Minister. The Question will be transmitted and the Minister will come back with an Answer.

Mr Ntekuni: Mr Speaker, thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We will move to the Question numbered 576, standing in the name of Ohene Kwame Frimpong, Member of Parliament for Asante Akyem North.

Hon Members, we ask that the Answer be transmitted and published.

Extension of rural electrification in some communities

Mr Ohene Kwame Frimpong (Asante Akyem North): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition what plans are being implemented to extend the rural electrification project to the following communities in the Asante Akyem North municipality: (i) Oforikrobon (ii) Scorpion (iii) Niena (iv) Baamaa (v) Aworoso (vi) Abrekyiekrom (vii) Jabal.

Mr Gyan-Mensah: Oforikrobon, Scorpion, Niena, Baamaa, Aworoso, Abrekyiekrom and Jabal communities do not form part of any of the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition's ongoing electrification projects. The communities have been noted and would be considered for electrification when funds become available.

[Published by Order of Mr Speaker]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We will move to the Question numbered 591. Standing in the name of Mohammed Issah Bataglia, Member of Parliament for Sissala East.

Expansion of Electricity to Some Communities in Sissala East Constituency

Mr Mohammed Issah Bataglia (NDC - Sissala East): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition the plans of the Government to expand electricity to the following communities in the Sissala East Constituency: (i) Santijan, (ii) Gbenabisi

(iii) Kalaxy, (iv) Nahadakui (v) Kapunjan (vi) Tanla (vii) Nitalu (viii) Kwapung (ix) Wuru (x) Dinduarijan Katinia and seven other communities to the national grid.

2:55 p.m.

Mr Gyan-Mensah: The communities namely, (i) Santijan (ii) Gbenabisi (iii) Kalaxy (iv) Nahadakui (v) Kapunjan (vi) Tanla (vii) Nitalu (viii) Kwapung (ix) Wuru (x) Dinduarijan Katinia do not form part of any of the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition's current Rural Electrification Programme in the Sissala East Constituency of the Upper West Region. However, these communities will be considered in subsequent electrification programme when funds are available.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any supplementary question?

Mr Bataglia: Not directly, but only to inform the Minister that applications have been put in that regard and bill of quantities to have been submitted to his office. We hope that when the funds are available, he will consider Sissala East. Thank you.

Status of Work on Baweisiboi and Kormor Rural Electrification Project

Mr Mohammed Issah Bataglia (NDC — Sissala East): I beg to ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition the status of work on the Baweisiboi and Kormor Rural Electrification project.

Mr Gyan-Mensah: High Voltage (HV), Low Voltage (LV), Substation and customer service works have been completed at Baweisiboi. The community has been connected to the National Electricity Grid with over 290 customers enjoying electricity since the year 2018.

Kormor no. 1 and Kormor no. 2 form part of the Ministry's ongoing SHEP-5 Rural Electrification Project in the Sissala East District of the Upper West Region.

High Voltage (HV) and Low Voltage (LV) works have been completed at Kormor no. 1 and Kormor no.2. Transformers have been supplied and mounted. However, 7km out of 12km HV line serving Kormor no. 1 and Kormor no. 2 was vandalised in 2024. Subsequently, the Ministry has recently authorised the release of the electrical materials required to restore the vandalised network.

The Ministry is implementing a local turnkey project earmarked at completing all ongoing electrification projects in the Northern, Savannah and Upper West regions this year for which all the above-mentioned communities form part. This initiative is to eliminate delays associated with the traditional SHEP Projects.

Mr Bataglia: Mr Speaker, I would want to confirm that by thanking the Minister. I think the contractor contacted me to assist in how we are transporting the release materials to the district.

Thank you very much.

Support of Developmental Project in need of VRA resettlement in Communities in Fanteakwa North

Mr Kwame Appiah Kodua (NPP — Fanteakwa North): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition the plans the Ministry has to support developmental projects, which are in dire need of VRA Resettlement in the following communities in the Fanteakwa North District: (i) Dede – Sewirako, (ii) Onuku (iii) Dominase Quarters.

Mr Gyan-Mensah: The creation of the Akosombo Dam led to the acquisition of various sites to resettle persons who were affected. Consequently, 52 resettlements sites were created as a result of the Akosombo Dam Project, which include Dedeso Wireko, Onuku and Dominase.

On 22nd July, 1996, a Trust Deed was executed between Volta River Authority, the Government of Ghana, acting through the erstwhile Minister for Mines and Energy and First Trustees (consisting of selected MPs whose constituencies fall within VRA Resettlement Townships).

The Trust Deed established the VRA Resettlement Trust Fund (hereinafter referred to as "the Fund") which was established to carry out social and welfare projects and other needs for the benefit of the VRA resettlement communities.

Annual contribution of the Cedi equivalent of Five Hundred thousand United States Dollars (US\$500,000) is made to the Fund by the Volta River Authority. Since 1997, the Fund has supported the Dedeso Wireko, Onuku and Dominase Resettlement townships with various developmental projects in the area of education, health, sanitation, water, electricity and security among others.

Upon re-constitution of the Board of Trustees (Managing Trustees) of the Fund, it is envisaged that the Fund could consider supporting Dedeso Wireko, Onuku and Dominase communities with the following proposed projects, subject to the availability of funds and equitable allocation of funds among the 52 VRA resettlement townships and approval by the Managing Trustees of the Fund based on needs assessment:

Township	Proposed Project	Proposed Period
Dedeso Wireko	Assistance in Construction of Housing Unit for Ghana Police Service	2026 - 2028
Onuku	Rehabilitation of Kindergarten and 6-unit classroom block	2026-2027
Dominase	Assistance in Water Project	2027 - 2028

For Onuku, there is rehabilitation of a kindergarten and six-unit classroom block, and the project is to be undertaken between 2026 to 2027. In Dominase, the proposed project is to help them with a water project and the period for consideration is 2027 to 2028.

However, Mr Speaker, these communities have actually benefited from several projects under the resettlement.

If we look at a community like Dedeso Wireko, they have had drilling of boreholes, rehabilitation of five-unit toilets, rehabilitation of primary school, supply of school furniture, construction of kitchen and baths, supply of solar power electrification, district

water programme, renovation of schools, construction of Junior High School J.H.S., construction of a community centre, reshaping of roads, drilling of four boreholes, repairs of works on community centre, supply of furniture for schools, and a lot of it.

On the next community, that is Onuku, their school building was re-roofed in 1998, rehabilitation of the school in 1998, construction of Kumasi Ventilated Improved Pit (KVIP) 2002, construction of three units, and one three-seater KVIP 2003, and recently construction of a six-unit teacher's accommodation in 2013.

For Dominase, the most recent project that was undertaken was a rehabilitation

of a JHS and primary school block, that is in 2013. In the previous years, they have had no less than 14 projects undertaken.

Mr Kodua: Not all Members of Parliament (MPs) in the resettlement communities are on the Trust Fund Board. Will the Ministry consider to hold annual meeting with all MPs who have resettlement —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, file a new Question. That cannot be a supplementary question.

Mr Kodua: Mr Speaker, let me reframe the supplementary question.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, how are you going to reframe this? Your Question is on the “support developmental project which are in dire need of VRA Resettlement in the following communities” and you are talking about membership of a board.

Mr Kodua: Mr Speaker, with respect, give me the opportunity. What I am seeking to ask the Minister whether the MPs in the resettlement communities, going into the future —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, the question is overruled.

Mr Kodua: I have no option, Mr Speaker.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. I maintain that we take this. The reason

is that you do not take the Minister by surprise; he must be aware. That is why the supplementary question is limited to the scope of the Question that you have asked. You are asking for development project support in certain communities, and then you are coming to ask a supplementary question on the membership of Members of Parliament in resettlement areas on the board. It is clearly a different thing and it really offends Standing Order 89.

3:05 p.m.

The rules are clear that when a person presiding is speaking, you listen to the person in silence. It is even disorderly on your part. If you are doing the wrong thing and you are being corrected, you think you are right. You can ask your Seniors whether that is done.

Hon Members, let us move to Question numbered 605, standing in the name of Alhaji Alhassan Mumuni, Member of Parliament for Salaga North.

Efforts to Connect Selected Communities in the Salaga North Constituency to the National Electricity Grid

Alhaji Alhassan Mumuni (NDC — Salaga North): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition the effort the Ministry is making to connect the following communities in the Salaga North Constituency to the national grid: (i) Zankum (ii) Nom-nayili (iii) Chandayili (iv) Nyeshila (v) Nyeshila — Kpalguni (vi) Chihigu (vii) Chani (viii) Chihigu

Fulani Settlement (ix) Kpashegu – Kpalguni (x) Sungshe Fulani.

Mr Gyan-Mensah: Mr Speaker, the Zankum, Chandayili, and Nyeshila communities form part of the Ministry's ongoing Cost Sharing Project in the North East Gonja District of the Savannah Region. A total of 425 High Voltage (HV) poles required for these communities have been supplied and are yet to be planted. Most of the necessary pole-top materials have also been delivered. Additionally, 185 Low-Voltage (LV) poles required for the project have been supplied and installed in the communities. Most of the pole-top accessories have been provided, and conductor stringing has been completed in the above-mentioned communities.

With regard to the communities of Nom-nayili, Nyeshila–Kpalguni, Chihigu, Chani, Chihigu Fulani Settlement, and Sungshe Fulani, they are not recorded in the Ministry's documents. However, it was observed that some level of work has been undertaken in these areas by the sponsor (MP), using part of the materials originally released for the above-mentioned communities.

For example, installation works for both the HV and LV networks, together with transformers, have been completed at Nom-nayili and Chani. Low-Voltage works have also been completed at Chihigu, Chihigu Fulani Settlement, and Sungshe Fulani communities.

The Ministry is implementing a local turnkey project earmarked at completing

all ongoing electrification projects in the Northern, Savannah and Upper West Regions this year, for which all the above-mentioned communities form part. This initiative is to eliminate delays associated with the traditional SHEP projects. So, under this initiative, the communities will be attended to.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any supplementary questions?

Alhaji Alhassan Mumuni: Mr Speaker, yes.

The Nom-nayili, Chani, and Kpashegu – Kpalguni communities have indeed been completed by my support, and they are awaiting metres. Could the Minister assure us when we will get metres to be able to connect these communities as soon as practicable?

Mr Gyan-Mensah: The Ministry has just received some metres. So, as part of the ongoing turnkey project, we will expedite work within the communities. We will give it the needed attention and will not wait for the contractor to take his own time. So, Hon Member, be assured we will attend to it.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any further supplementary questions?

Alhaji Alhassan Mumuni: Mr Speaker, no.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We then move to the Question numbered 606, also standing in the name of Alhaji Alhassan Mumuni.

Planned Interventions to Extend National Grid Electricity to Selected Underserved Communities

Alhaji Alhassan Mumuni (NDC — Salaga North): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Energy and Green Transition the plans the Ministry has to connect the following communities to the national grid: (i) Bavim (ii) Komlanyili (iii) Kaa (iv) Changbuni (v) Diffisa (vi) Kejipulari (vii) Dingoni (viii) Gbeteni (ix) Chanayili (x) Epuneyirema (xi) Kpalan (xii) Ruwandogo Bator.

Mr Gyan-Mensah: Mr Speaker, the communities namely, Bavim, Komlanyli, Kaa, Changbuni, Diffisa, Kejipulari, Dingoni, Gbeteni, Chanayili, Epuneyirema, Kpalan and Ruwandogo Bator, do not form part of any of the Ministry's ongoing electrification projects. The Ministry is implementing a local turnkey project earmarked at completing all ongoing electrification projects in the Northern, Savannah and Upper West Regions and will consider the above-mentioned communities for electrification when there is sufficient balance of funding under the above-mentioned project.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any supplementary question?

Alhaji Alhassan Mumuni: No supplementary question. Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, Question time has ended. On your behalf, I thank the Hon Deputy Minister for Energy and Green Transition for attending upon the House

to respond to the scheduled Questions. Accordingly, you are hereby discharged. Once again, thank you for coming.

Majority Leadership?

Ms Comfort Doyoe Cudjoe: Mr Speaker, we are to do the Legal Education Reform Bill, 2025, on page 9, the item numbered 16.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, Hon Members, the request is to do the Legal Education Reform Bill, 2025.

Mr Collins Adomako-Mensah: Mr Speaker, I am not too sure if we are ready. I cannot see the Chairman—Chairman, where is the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice? The Deputy Attorney-General and Deputy Minister for Justice is not here, and the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice himself is not here.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, if we are not even going to do the Business, let us not set a bad precedent. I maintain that Article 93(2) vests the legislative power in Parliament. The exercise of the legislative power, vested in Parliament, is not tied to any member of the Executive. So, when we come here and say that we cannot exercise that legislative power because the Minister is not here, then we should look at the constitutional implications of what we are placing on record.

Does it mean that if a Minister is not in this House, we cannot make a law? So that will be controlled by the Executive, as and when they want the Minister to

come? After the introduction of the Bill, it is in the domain of Parliament.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, let us do a few clauses as we discussed at Conclave today.

3:14 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the Legal Education Reform Bill, 2025 at the Consideration Stage.

BILL — CONSIDERATION STAGE

Legal Education Reform Bill, 2025

*[Resumption of consideration from
18/02/2026]*

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Clause 25, Chairperson of the Committee?

Clause 25 — Application for full accreditation licence

Chairperson of the Committee (Mr Shaibu Mahama): Mr Speaker, clause 25, amendment proposed is to *delete*—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, before you propose the amendment, do as agreed so that we can carry the Members along. Clause 25 in the old Bill is now—Was that not what we agreed on?

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, clause 25 in the original Bill is the same as what

is advertised. The difference, rather, is with the winnowed version.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes. So, which clause is it in the winnowed version?

Mr S. Mahama: So, it is clause 27 in the winnowed version. Mr Speaker, what we did was to collapse clause 25 and merge it with clause 24. So, the reason we are deleting clause 25. So, the new rendition—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, what you ought to say is that since we are deleting clause 25 in its entirety in the original version, we will not find it in the winnowed version.

Mr S. Mahama: Very well. So, the new rendition will be:

“Application for full accreditation licence.

A university that is issued with a provisional accreditation licence shall, within two years after the issue of the provisional accreditation licence, apply for a full accreditation licence from the Council”.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, are you reading from page 9? “Clause 25, amendment proposed, *delete*.”

Mr S. Mahama: We merged the clauses 25 and 24, and that is what I am reading from the winnowed version, clause 27.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, so you should move the amendment in the *Order Paper*, so that we put a Question on it, which will indicate that clause 25 has been deleted. Then when you move to the next clause, you move amendment on clause 27.

So, propose the amendment as per (i).

Hon Member, the proposal before us is that clause 25 be *deleted*. It is for the consideration of the House. Chairperson of the Committee, is that not the amendment?

Mr S. Mahama: Yes, Mr Speaker.

Prof Kingsley Nyarko: Mr Speaker, I am getting a bit confused, because the revised Bill that we have been using ever since has clause 25, but I do not know when this merger of clauses 25 and 24 came about. I have the one we have been using all along, and that has clauses 25 and 24. I am kind of confused, so kindly educate me further.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Prof Nyarko, do you have the original Bill? So, the original clause 25 is proposed to be *deleted*.

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, clauses 24 and 25 are now merged as clause 27.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, so the merger will be in the document of the Winnowing Committee. But your proposal here, that clause 25 be *deleted*, is to the original Bill.

Mr S. Mahama: Yes, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: That was why I was urging upon you to move the amendment as captured in the *Order Paper*.

Mr S. Mahama: So, Mr Speaker, the proposed amendment in the *Order Paper* is to *delete* clause 25.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So that is for the consideration of the House.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Clause 25 ordered to be deleted from the Bill.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, amendment (ii). Chairperson of the Committee?

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, amendment proposed to clause 27. *Add* the following new clause. Indeed, Mr Speaker, clause 27 has been taken already a few days ago, and the Question taken on it. The minutes will bear that out.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, I do not know why it should still appear on the *Order Paper*.

Very well. In view of the fact that clause 27 has been taken already, I direct that we move to the next clause. We stopped at clause 31 so the next clause for us to continue with is clause 32.

Yes, Chairperson of the Committee?

Clause 32 — Revocation of accreditation licence.

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, clause 32 of the original Bill matches with clause 34 of the winnowed Bill.

Mr Speaker, amendment proposed:
Add the following new subclause:

“Where an accreditation licence is revoked under this section;

(a) persons already enrolled in Law Practice Training at the university at the time of revocation shall complete the law programme as if the university continued to hold the requisite accreditation licence; and

(b) the university shall not enroll or admit new persons to Law Practice Training without obtaining a valid accreditation licence under this Act., *delete* paragraph (b).”.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the proposed amendment is for the consideration of the House to add the new clauses as captured on page 10.

Any further amendments?

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Clause 34, as amended, ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Chairperson of the Committee, clause 33?

Clause 33 — Inspection of accredited universities.

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, clause 33 in the original Bill is now clause 35 in the document of the Winnowing Committee.

Amendment proposed: Subclause (1), *delete* and *insert* the following:

“(1) The Council shall carry out inspections of accredited universities every three years.”

I so move, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Members, it is for your consideration. Any further amendments?

3:25 p.m.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Chairperson of the Committee, amendment number (vi). Very well, this is an amendment in favour of the Minority Leader, Osahen Alexander Kwamena Afenyo-Markin. Is anybody here with the authority to move that amendment? What is the decision of the Winnowing Committee?

Mr Adomako-Mensah: Mr Speaker, he is not here himself, and he has not

given me the reason for this particular amendment.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Do we defer the amendment or take it as second consideration? Yes, Chairperson of the Committee.

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, we can then move to (vii).

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Mr S. Mahama: Amendment proposed, subclause (2), line 3, *delete*—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We are putting a Question on the entire clause 33? Alright, there is amendment numbered (vii). So, should we defer his amendment and defer the consideration of the clause or if he feels strong, we take it at second consideration?

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, let us take it.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. So, let us move to (vii).

Yes?

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, regarding the amendment proposed by the Minority Leader, I think that it is an amendment that is worthy to be considered. It must be part of the Bill because it says,

“and the Council shall ensure that inspections are conducted at least once in each semester to ensure continuous compliance with the prescribed standards.”

This is about quality assurance so I support this proposed amendment from the Leader.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Prof, nobody in this House indicated that it is not an amendment that is not worthy for consideration. This is a House of record so when certain things are placed on record and it is looked at tomorrow, it will appear to the Minority Leader as if his amendment is being considered not worthy. That is a wrong impression. We are looking for somebody who has the authority to either move the amendment on his behalf, we defer the amendment, or we put the question so that when he feels strong, he can come and take it as second consideration.

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, I agree with you. I have to withdraw the word “worthy” but because you asked the Chairperson his position on that, that was why I came back and suggested that we should consider it than deferring it.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: No, the position that I asked the Chairperson is that, are we deferring for second consideration, or the Winnowing Committee has a position on this? So, he said we should continue and that is why I called the item numbered (vii).

Chairperson of the Committee, the item numbered (vii)?

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, the item numbered (vii), amendment proposed, Subclause (2), line 3, *delete* “Commission” and *insert* “Council”.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Clause 33 as amended ordered to stand part of the Bill

Clause 34 — Appeal

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, amendment proposed – Paragraph (c), line 2, after “Education” *delete* “Reform”. I so move.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Clause 34 as amended ordered to stand part of the Bill

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Chairperson of the Committee?

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, Sectional note before clause 35 – amendment proposed – *Delete* “Degree”. I so move.

Question put and amendment agreed to

Sectional note as amended ordered to stand part of the Bill

Clause 35 ordered to stand part of the Bill

Clause 36 — Dean of law Degree programme

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, amendment proposed – subclause (1), line 1, after “law”, *delete* “degree”,

and in line 2, after “law”, *delete* “degree”.

I so move, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, I will put the Question on clause 36 and give consequential directive to the drafters to accordingly do the deletion of degree at the relevant sections.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

The drafters should kindly take note and do all the consequential amendments.

Again, clause 36. It is also consequential. Hon Members, this is a consequential amendment. I have already directed the drafters, but I will put the Question.

Question put and amendment agreed to

Clause 36 as amended ordered to stand part of the Bill

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Same applies to item numbered (xii) on page 11 so I consequentially direct. So, let us take the item numbered (xiii).

Mr S. Mahama: Amendment proposed – Subclause (2), as captured on page 11, paragraph (a) *delete* and *insert* the following:

“(a) is of a rank of

(i) a Senior Lecturer and holds a Doctor of Philosophy in Law; or

(ii) an Associate Professor of Law or above;”

I so move, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the proposed amendment is for your consideration. Any further amendments? In the absence of any further amendments, I will put a Question to the proposed amendment.

3:35 p.m.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

Amendment proposed – subclause (2), paragraph (e), *delete* “Ghana Bar Association” and *insert* “Bar”.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

Amendment proposed – Subclause (2), paragraph (g), line 3, after “law”, *delete* “degree”.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

Amendment proposed – Subclause (2), paragraph (h), *delete*.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Clause 36 as amended ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Clause 37— Functions of the Dean

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, I know that clause 37 xvii—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, I directed that the drafters do the consequential amendment and tidy it up.

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, the entire clause 37 up to xxix.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the amendments proposed to clause 37 are all consequential to *delete* “degree”. So, I will put the question on all the amendments together.

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

Amendment proposed – Opening phrase, after “law”, *delete* “degree”.

Amendment Proposed – Paragraph (a), line 1, after “law” *delete* “degree”.

Amendment proposed – Paragraph (b), line 1, after “law”, *delete* “degree”.

Amendment proposed – Paragraph (c), line 2, after “law”, *delete* “degree”.

Amendment proposed – Paragraph (d), line 2, after “law”, *delete* “degree”.

Amendment proposed – Paragraph (e), line 2, after “law”, *delete* “degree”.

Amendment proposed – Paragraph (f), line 1, after “law” *delete* “degree”.

Amendment proposed – Paragraph (g), line 1, after “law”, *delete* “degree”, and in line 2, after “law” *delete* “degree”.

Amendment proposed – Paragraph (h), line 1, after “law”, *delete* “degree”. Amendment proposed – Paragraph (i), line 2, after, “law”, *delete* “degree”.

Amendment proposed – Paragraph (j), line 1, *delete* “degree”.

Amendment proposed – Paragraph (k), line 2, after “law”, *delete* “degree”.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Clause 37 as amended ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Clause 38 — Administrator of Law Degree Programme.

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, Clause 38 as in xxx and xxxi are the same.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, in the same vein, I

consequently direct the drafters to take note and *delete* “degree” accordingly.

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

Amendment proposed – Opening phrase, line 1, after “law”, *delete* “degree”.

Amendment proposed – Paragraph (e), line 2, *delete* “degree”.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Clause 38 as amended ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Clause 39 — Functions of Administrator.

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, the same for Clause 39.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, I consequently direct the drafters to tidy it up. It has to do with the same deletion of the word “degree”.

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

Amendment proposed – Headnote, after “law”, *delete* “degree”.

Amendment proposed – Paragraph (a), line 1, after “law”, *delete* “degree”.

Amendment proposed – Paragraph (c), line 1, after “law”, *delete* “degree”.

Amendment proposed – Paragraph (d), line 1, after “law”, *delete* “degree”.

Amendment proposed – Paragraph (e), line 1, after “law”, *delete* “degree”.

Amendment proposed – Paragraph (f), lines 2, after “law”, *delete* “degree”, and in 3, after “law”, *delete* “degree”.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Clause 39 as amended ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Clause 40 — Account Officer of Law Degree Programme.

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, the same is for clause 40.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the same consequential directive for clauses 40 and 42. Chairperson of the Committee, is that so?

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, it is clauses 40 and 41.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, I direct that all consequential amendments leading to the deletion of “degree” be taken as in clauses 40, 41 and 42.

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

Amendment proposed – Headnote, after “law”, *delete* “degree”.

Amendment proposed – Line 2, after “law”, *delete* “degree”.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Clause 40 as amended ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Clause 41 — Functions of Account Officer.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: It is also consequential. I direct the drafters to take note of it.

Prof Kingsley Nyarko: Mr Speaker, clause 41(c). I propose that, instead of “status”, we use “position”. So, we would *delete* “status” and *insert* “position”.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Do we say ‘financial status’ or ‘position’?

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, I think ‘position’ is better.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

Amendment proposed – Opening phrase, line 1, after “law”, *delete* “degree”.

Amendment proposed – Paragraph (a), line 1, after “law”, *delete* “degree”

Amendment proposed – Paragraph (b), line 1, after “law”, *delete* “degree”.

Amendment proposed – Paragraph (c), line 3, after “law”, *delete* “degree”.

Amendment proposed – Paragraph (d), line 2, *delete* “degree”.

Amendment proposed – Paragraph (e), line 1, after “law”, *delete* “degree”.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Clause 41 as amended ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Clause 42 — Records of Law Degree Programme.

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

Amendment proposed – Headnote, after “law”, *delete* “degree”.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

Amendment proposed – Subclause (1), opening phrase, *delete* “A person in charge of the law degree programme of a university” and *insert* “A university that runs a law programme”

Question put and amendment agreed to.

3:45 p.m.

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, the remaining amendments to clause 42, are all consequential as you directed earlier.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Drafters, kindly take note and do the consequential amendments.

Hon Members, any further amendments to clause 42?

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Clause 42 as amended ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Yes, LI, sectional note.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Chairperson of the Committee, the item numbered 16 (li), Sectional note before clause 43?

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, with the sectional note, the same consequential directive from you applies.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Sectional note before clause 43 as amended ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Clause 43 — Admission examination and entrance standards.

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, amendment proposed, sub clause (1), *delete* “A person in charge of the law

degree programme of a university” and insert “A university that runs a law programme.

I so move, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The proposed amendment is for the consideration of the House.

Hon Members, any counter proposal?

Question put and amended agreed to.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the item numbered 16 (l) (ii), clause 43.

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, sub clause 2, paragraph (b), *delete* and *insert* the following: “(b) Has a first degree.”

I so move, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: It is for the consideration of the House.

Hon Members, any further amendment?

Question put and amended agreed to.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the item numbered 16 (liv), clause 43?

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, amendment proposed, add the following new sub clause:

“The minimum class requirement for admission to the professional Law Practice Training Course shall be

determined and published by the Council and shall be binding on all universities, and no university shall independently vary that requirement.”

I so move.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: This is in the name, again, of the Minority Leader. So, as usual, if you have the authority.

Mr Ayeh: No, Mr Speaker, just like we did for the other one. We do not have the authority, so —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

So, it may be taken at the Second Consideration Stage.

Clause 43 as amended ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Clause 44 and 45 ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Clause 46 — Curriculum for Bachelor of Laws Degree Programme.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Chairperson of the Committee, any amendment?

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, it is also by Osahen Alexander Kwame Afenyo-Markin.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. So, it is by the same implication.

Very well.

Let me put the Question on clause 46

comprehensive curriculum for Bachelor of Laws degree programme”.

Dr F. K. Asamoah: Mr Speaker, in addition to the amendment from the Hon Minority Leader, I would like to propose a further amendment. Since GTEC is in charge of the curriculum for Bachelor —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Has the amendment of the Minority Leader been carried?

Why are you proposing an amendment to the amendment of the Minority Leader that has not been carried?

Dr F. K. Asamoah: Mr Speaker, no, it is not to his; it is a separate amendment to clause 46.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, why is it in addition to the amendment of the Minority Leader?

Dr F. K. Asamoah: All right.

So, it is not in addition to that, rather, I am proposing an amendment to clause 46.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Dr F. K. Asamoah: Mr Speaker, since GTEC is in charge of the National Qualification Framework, I propose that where it says “the Council shall, in consultation with accredited universities, develop a comprehensive curriculum for Bachelor of Laws degree programme” I propose that we insert “the Council shall, in consultation with GTEC and accredited universities, develop a

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, did we agree that instead of “universities”, we use “institutions”? This is consequential; The Drafters, take note; whenever you see “universities”, appropriately substitute it with “institutions”.

The amendment is for your consideration. Let me place on record that the proposed amendment to clause 46 is clause 48 in the Winnowing Committee document, which is the Curriculum for Bachelor of Laws degree programme.

It is for the consideration of the House. Chairperson of the Committee, what do you say to it?

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, could he explain further why GTEC should be part of this consultation?

Dr F. K. Asamoah: Mr Speaker, the GTEC is the custodian of the National Qualification Framework, which goes all the way up to terminal degrees. This is a law programme which will lead to law practice and I believe that GTEC cannot be taken out of this curriculum, which would be developed for law programmes. That is why I am suggesting that we make sure that not only the universities but also, GTEC has to have the approval of the law programme.

I so submit.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Chairperson of the Committee?

Mr S. Mahama: Well, Mr Speaker, it is in consultation anyway. We can add as many as we want to consult.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Is it the case that as part of the Bill, you stated somewhere that “the Council shall, in collaboration with GTEC”— I am just trying to look for it.

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, I have not cited any. My comfort is that it is a consultation. Consultation is not fatal.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Because I am just looking for it. I know I have read somewhere in the Bill that you said “A Council in collaboration with GTEC...”, and you have even quoted the GTEC Accreditation Act. So, for the sake of consistency —

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, in which case, it is not fatal to add GTEC. Is it?

3:55 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Look at clause 3 (a).

“...accredited institution to provide professional legal education and training in the country in accordance with paragraph (b) of subsection 3 of section 8 of the Education Regulatory Bodies Act—

“...in collaboration with the Ghana Tertiary Education Commission, set

the standard for the accreditation of law programme in institutions.”

Hon Members, I will put the Question and direct the draftsman to put it in the proper perspective. Yes, Dr A. K. T. Mahama.

Dr A. K. T. Mahama: Mr Speaker, I take notice of your direction, but I want to make the point that the rendition here should be consistent with Section 3, because we discussed in this House the turf between the area of GTEC and what we want the Council to deal with and I think we were very clear in our minds that when it comes to the law programmes, it is within the turf of GTEC. GTEC will still want to continue to be the one leading in this particular but we also admit that the Council would have a role to play in collaboration with GTEC in ensuring that we have the curriculum for the law programme.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: That is why I want to put a question on his proposed amendment and allow the draftsman to put it in a drafting language for us, because of the element of the use of the word in collaboration. For consistency’s sake, they will go and check the relevant clause and then the draftsman—

Dr A. K. T. Mahama: Mr Speaker, just to note that the mention of accredited universities here is a bit problematic for me. That is why I am just asking for consistency with Section 3, as previously agreed to. Thank you very much.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We said this is a consequential amendment. The universities will be replaced by institutions, consequentially. Maybe state your rendition again so that Hon Members can follow you.

Dr F. K. Asamoah: Thank you very much. Mr Speaker, the reason for which in developing curriculum, we have to be mindful of the—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We have agreed on the principle. Just come up with your rendition.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, we need to pay attention to the clause that follows. The clause that follows is “content of curriculum”. We see that the law itself actually details the curriculum.

Clause 49 says:

“1. The curriculum for a Bachelor of Laws degree programme shall provide

(a) instructions that are necessary for the impartation of a particular subject matter or skill;

(b) practical and theoreticall training, training in the law;

(c) an opportunity to take elective courses;

(d) training in information technology, having ...

2. The Council shall review the curriculum every five years to

take account of new development in the law.”

Do you think it is still necessary for the Commission to be consulted in this matter?

Dr F. K. Asamoah: Mr Speaker, exactly so. The Commission like I said, is in charge of the national qualification framework. Every qualification, it does not matter which profession that is attained in the country, they are the regulators of it.

If we look at the details, the clause that follows, this condition could even change, because curriculum is dynamic. The national qualification ensures that this dynamic nature of curriculum is adhered to. So, it is still very important and necessary that we keep GTEC in place for clause 46.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, let us look at the clause carefully. It reads,

“The council shall, in consultation with accredited institutions, develop a comprehensive curriculum for a Bachelor of Laws degree.”

Is GTEC responsible for accreditation, or they are also responsible for development of the curriculum? They give accreditation based on the curriculum. So why would you involve GTEC in the development of the curriculum? That is why the rendition is saying that the Council must develop the curriculum with the accredited

universities. Before they will be doing that—

Yes, Hon Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Ordinarily, I think the curriculum is approved by the Commission. Normally, in accrediting a university, they approve the curriculum as part of what they look at, to determine if you should offer a degree in that programme. But I think the objective of this legislation is to place that responsibility in the hands of the Council.

But he is saying that given the traditional role of the Commission in developing and approving curriculum for universities in the process of accreditation, it will be good that we provide for some consultative role for the Commission. The Chairperson is not opposed to it.

Chairperson, are you opposed to that?
Chairperson says he does not.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, we need to look at the defined role of the Commission. That is why it says in collaboration, they will set the standard. So, what has been said in clause 3 is that they set the standard in collaboration. Do you understand?

Dr F. K. Asamoah: Mr Speaker, in practice, even though we set the standard, which is based on the National Qualification Framework, it gives one the identifiers. But when it comes to the process, it is critical that one involves GTEC in the process; GTEC who is the

regulator and set the standards. And remember, the standards are also being set in collaboration.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I am not an educationist, but with my knowledge in the passage of the Education Regulatory Bodies Act, they set the standard. You go and develop your curriculum in line with the standard and they would give an approval. Now, if GTEC is now going to develop the curriculum with them, how can they develop the curriculum with them and again be an inspector? Yes, let me hear Hon Kingsley Nyarko and I will come to Mr Nortsu-Kotoe.

Prof K. Nyarko: Mr Speaker, I just stepped out briefly. Normally, what happens is that the standards are determined by the regulators. So we give opportunity to the institutions to develop the curriculum based on those standards. That is how it is done. As a regulator, they cannot come up with the curriculum. They only give the guidelines and indicators. They expect the faculties to follow the standards, prepare the curriculum so they can judge them based on that. That is how it is done in the process.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: That is why I am of the view that if you carry his amendment, GTEC is going to be a judge in their own court.

Prof K. Nyarko: I did not hear his amendment.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: He said that the development of the curriculum

should be in collaboration with GTEC, or it should be in consultation with GTEC, while GTEC has set the standards.

Prof K. Nyarko: GTEC must use the standards to judge the curriculum.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: But now GTEC is now going to be involved in the development. Is that how it is done?

Dr F. K. Asamoah: Mr Speaker, how will GTEC know that the standard that has been set in clause 3 (b) is consistent with the standard? We will have to go further to—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Let me hear Mr Nortsu-Kotoe.

Mr Peter Nortsu-Kotoe: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

4:05 p.m.

Mr Speaker as I said earlier, GTEC is involved in setting the standards and when the standards are set, the various institutions draw their own curriculum. Before accreditation is given, GTEC has a team that will review the curriculum that is presented by the various institutions. So, you cannot set the standards, prepare the curriculum and then approve for the institutions; it does not go that way. We will leave GTEC out at this level.

Mr Speaker, that is how it is being done.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, so, Dr Fred Kyei Asamoah, if you are not convinced, propose your amendment and let me put the question.

Yes, Majority Leader?

Mr Mahama Ayariga: I get the sense of the direction from the Speaker. If he still insists that the Commission should play a role, then we can only reinforce the role of the Commission in setting standards. Is that all right—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Majority Leader, by this Act, the Commission is by law mandated to set the standards and approve the curriculum. But this clause is saying that, the council shall, in consultation with the institutions, develop the comprehensive curriculum, which must meet the standard set by GTEC, then they approve.

Now his amendment will bring GTEC into the development of this comprehensive curriculum, which is not proper.

Mr Ayariga: Yes. So that is why I thought that if he has a proposal, it can only be in accord with the role of the Commission in setting standards. So, one could come to clause 48 (2) (b), that is the new rendition, and say:

“The curriculum developed under subclause 1 shall,

a. accord with contemporary demands for legal services,

- b. provide for the recruitment of competent and committed teaching staff for the university, and;
- c. meet the standards set by the Commission.”

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, I do not have a problem with that.

Dr F. K. Asamoah: I also do not, because that makes sure that the approval process is also taken care of.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: But automatically, they have to approve and if they do not approve, they would not give them the accreditation.

Dr F. K. Asamoah: Yes, but if they give you approval to develop curriculum, they have to make sure that the standard that they have given you is adhered to. Because we will be leaving an amendment to it. So, we would go with the approval—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Prof Kingsley Nyarko?

Dr F. K. Asamoah: I will want to propose that we go with—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, he has something to say to what Minority Leader is proposing, that is why I am giving him the floor.

Prof K. Nyarko: When the curricula are approved by the regulator, to ensure that those standards are met. There are

periodic audits and institutional visits to ensure that there is compliance.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The inspections?

Prof K. Nyarko: Yes, because when I was at National Accreditation Board (NAB), now GTEC, we have academic audits. We also have periodic visits to ensure that the curriculum is implemented according to guidelines and standards that are set. That is how one can ensure that there is compliance. One cannot just have the curriculum without doing anything. So, there are institutional measures that we put in place to ensure that all these things are done.

But a regulator preparing a curriculum at the same time; it does not work. It is not the right way to go.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I think the proposer has agreed and he intends to drop his proposed amendment.

Dr F. K. Asamoah: I dropped the proposed amendment in clause 46(a) provided and turned to clause 46 to add an additional sub-clause, as was also suggested by the Majority Leader, to make sure that GTEC’s approval process is not left out.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, what would be the rendition? We would not have the (c) now?

Dr F. K. Asamoah: So, add “c” to clause 46(2) — the quote “set by GTEC”, I am fine with it. I am fine with

the “in collaboration”. That of the “meets the standards set by the Council and the Commission”, since the Commission is defined in the interpretation.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Member?

Mr Ayariga: I am saying that even there, we need to repeat the rendition in clause 3(a) and (b), because Clause 3(a) says,

“...standards set by Council in collaboration with the Commission.”

So, if we now come to clause 46(c), you must repeat that rendition and meet the standards set by the Council and the Commission. Just add to “c”,

“...meet the standards set by the Council in collaboration with the Commission.”

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, drafters, is it possible we cross-reference it to clause 3 to meet the standard set in clause 3(b)? Very well.

So, it reads;

“...and meet the standard set by the Council and the GTEC.” I will then put a question. Yes, Hon Member?

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Prof Kingsley Nyarko?

Prof Kingsley Nyarko: Mr Speaker, with respect, 2 (b), “...provide for the recruitment of competent and committed teaching staff for the university”. I propose we *delete* the word “committed”, so that we have it read; “... provide for the recruitment of competent teaching staff for the university.” If you add committed teaching staff—In recruitment, how do you determine that, when the person has not even started doing their work? So, I am suggesting that we retain the word “competent” and *delete* “committed.”

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Did you say that cannot be determined? You are a professor in Parliament, when you applied to be a teaching staff, from the background that you are a professor, and competent. However, because you are a Member of Parliament, your membership of Parliament will affect the level of your commitment.

Prof K. Nyarko: Mr Speaker, the point I am making is that, clause 46 (1) says;

“The Council shall, in consultation with accredited universities, develop a comprehensive curriculum for a Bachelor of Laws degree programme. The curriculum developed and associated with (1) shall, accord with contemporary demands for legal services and provide for the recruitment of competent and committed teaching staff for the university.”

Mr First Deputy Speaker: You want us to do away with the word “committed.”

Prof K. Nyarko: In determining who is competent, that one can be easily done because of your qualification and credentials. But as to your commitment on the job, it is difficult to ascertain.

So, we do not have to put ourselves in uncharted, futuristic...

4:15 p.m.

Prof K. Nyarko: In uncharted futuristic temptations.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, let me hear from the Chairperson of the Committee.

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, let me admonish my very good Friend to abandon competence and commitment. We are recruiting people, their *Curriculum Vitae* (CV) and all the things about them is about their commitment to wherever they are coming from. So, it is not when we recruit them, it is where we are taking them from. We are assessing the commitment of what they were doing before recruitment. So, remember it says the council provides for the recruitment of competence. So, they are going to recruit from somewhere. The competence of that person is determined at where he was, where the person was picked from, not when he was brought in. So that is why the two words will go competence and commitment. So, the commitment of that person before recruitment, they should have done due

diligence. They should have done their *recce*. So, if they are poaching a professor from the University of Professional Studies, Accra (UPSA) to the University of Ghana, they should have done their *recce* to know the commitment of that person and the competence at where he is currently working before bringing him in. That is the essence of this.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: In addition to that, the Chairperson of the Committee is qualified to be a judge. Hon John Darko is qualified to be a judge. But he has a certificate from Parliament to hold Office of Profits. So, he applied to be a judge. By looking at his commitment in Parliament, if you are looking for committed people to be a judge, would you take him as one of those people to be a judge? His competence is not in dispute, but his commitment level may be in dispute.

Prof K. Nyarko: Mr Speaker, if you listen carefully to my very good Friend, Hon Shaibu, he was not specific even regarding the commitments of the person you are recruiting. He kept saying “if”. In recruitment, there is criteria. Unless I am told that there is a measure, an indicator that determines how committed the individual is. But in terms of competence, it can be verified from what they do; their outputs, their input, their qualifications, can be ascertained. Unless there is a measurable indicator to ascertain the commitment level of the individual, it is difficult to know. We can assume that this person is committed based on a question that has been asked of them. But in reality, it might not be the

case. So, for me, this is my observation. I am not bound by it. It is subject to the House to determine whether you can easily know.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Professor, would the commitment affect you in the event you want to teach in the institution? Because you are already a Member of Parliament, would you be committed?

Prof K. Nyarko: Commitment is a virtue. It is a variable that we need to achieve results. But they do not have to be assumed. They need to be verified.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: But with some, we can see it clearly with what the person is involved in—

Prof K. Nyarko: Mr Speaker, but for me, you can easily tell I am committed. Can you not?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: No. If I am asked to employ you to teach, particularly for the law degree, and you are a Member of Parliament, unless it is on the basis of part-time, I will not take you as a staff. You may not be available when you are needed because of Parliamentary duties.

Prof K. Nyarko: Commitment should not be seen in that perspective alone. On the job, it might be seen. It is not when I am a Member of Parliament and I want to also teach somewhere. On the job, it might be manifested, and all this—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Do you not agree that conditions precedent can

lead you to determine the person's commitment?

Prof K. Nyarko: Speaker, today is Friday. I would not want to belabour this point. So, let us put the Question —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I put the Question already or do you want me to put a Question on your deletion?

Prof K. Nyarko: Yes, please.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: No, I put the Question on the amendments of Hon Kyei Asamoah and that of the Leader. So, I would put a Question on the entire clause 46.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Clause 46 as amended ordered to be stand part of the Bill.

Clause 47 — Content of curriculum.

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, I beg to move clause 1, paragraph (d), line 1, after technology, *delete* “and the law”.

I so move.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the proposed amendment is for your consideration. Any further amendments?

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Ivii, clause 47.

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, I beg to move, subclause 1, paragraph (e), *delete*.

I so move.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The proposal is to delete subclause 1. It is for your consideration. Any further amendments?

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: lviii, Chairperson of the Committee?

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, I beg to move, amendment proposed, subclause 1, paragraph (f), line 2, after “relevant” *insert* “statutes”.

I so move.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: lix. Chairperson of the Committee?

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, I beg to move, subclause 1, paragraph (f), line 2, *insert* “statutes” after “relevant.”

I so move.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, this is consequential.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: lx, Chairperson of the Committee?

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, I beg to move, subclause 2, line 1, after curriculum *delete* “on a yearly basis” and *insert* “every five years”.

I so move.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, any further amendments?

Question put and amendment agreed to.

4:25 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, I would put a Question on entire clause 47.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Clause 47 as amended ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Clause 48 — Minimum requirement for Bachelor of Laws degree.

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, I beg to move, subclause 1, line 5, before “degree”, *delete* “law” and *insert* “Bachelor of Laws”.

I so move.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The proposed amendment is for the consideration of the House. Any further amendment?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I do not know whether, when we go to the Interpretation clause, we are likely to give meaning to “Bachelor of Laws”. The reason I say this is lately, in the United Kingdom (UK), we know that people pursue diploma in Law or postgraduate diploma in Law, with the same weight as the LLB. So, I am looking at a situation where somebody has a first degree in, say, Political Science or Economics, and pursues the post-first degree Law, where in the UK, once the person does post-first degree law, it is not LLB, but it qualifies the person for the bar exam or the Legal Practice Course (LPC).

In a situation where the person has not done the Bar Vocational Course (BVC) or the LPC and comes to Ghana to study Law professionally – normally, there are seven law programmes that a person must pursue to qualify for a law degree, compulsorily. Now, if we restrict this to Bachelor of Laws, what this means is that we are shutting the door on any person who may have the Law degree but does not have it as LLB. So, I was going to propose that if we could say a “Bachelor of Laws or its equivalent”, so that those who may pursue this in other Commonwealth jurisdictions—

Mr Ayariga — *rose* —

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I see the Majority Leader up. I do not know his intervention, so I would want to sit and listen.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, again, we are going to run into difficulty.

So, if your proposal is that a definition should be given to Bachelor of Laws, then make that particular proposal. If it is agreeable to the House, then we will do it. Because I do not know what the proposal is in all that you have said. You started by asking whether we are going to provide a definition for it. So, is it the proposal that we should provide a definition for?

Mr Ayariga: That was why I was on my feet. I was trying to understand what had happened. Which clause were we putting the Question on?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I think we are now on clause 48.

Mr Ayariga: The item numbered 16 (lxi) — clause 48.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The amendment is to *delete* “law” and *insert* “Bachelor of Laws”. Throughout the Bill, the word we use is “Bachelor of Laws”, not “laws”.

Mr Ayariga: So, does he want us to have a definition for “Bachelor of Laws”?—*[Interruption]*—So, let us move quickly and get there.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I am putting this across to further assist the Chairperson of the Committee, so that at the Interpretation clause, we will factor that in when we are defining the Bachelor of Laws qualification, having in mind the fact that many people are pursuing the law programme in other Commonwealth jurisdictions. I just stated the

UK situation where somebody would pursue a first degree and once the person is pursuing a second degree in Law, they do not call it Bachelor of Laws. In Ghana, when a person has a first degree and is doing another Law programme, we ordinarily call it post first degree LLB, which is the LLB we know. In other universities, the LLB is done as a first degree and it does not need to be treated as a post-first degree programme.

So, I am saying that the likelihood is that somebody will pursue a Law programme and the certificate will not be titled LLB, but that Law programme that the person has pursued qualifies him or her to pursue the professional Law. If we limit this, we will have difficulty.

Mr Speaker, I say so because some 20 years ago, I recall, somebody, whose name I do not want to mention, had a diploma in a certain programme and had gone for a master's degree. In fact, the person had double master's degree and had applied to do Law. The issue that became a matter of public discourse was that their qualification was very clear, that LLB, but the person did not have a first degree, although the person had a university diploma and a master's degree. So, the person, though initially was given admission, was later denied, and people were very restrictive in interpretation.

I am trying to caution, so that as a House, we do not legislate in a manner that would put people in harm's way, that somebody will say if the legislators had intended an LLB or its equivalent, they would have stated so. So, I have no

problem with where we are, but I am just drawing the Chairperson's attention that as we get to the Interpretation clause, please bear that in mind and let us lift the UK situation. Because a lot of our people go to the UK to study, and a lot of them may be coming from the UK or even coming from the United States of America (USA), where, by the way, the nomenclature is not LLB.

We do the first degree and then do the Juris Doctor, which is JD and not LLB. So, if we say LLB, Bachelor of Laws, somebody coming from the USA with a Law degree will not have access and they will be there giving interpretation. So, let us have a broader interpretation that recognises a Law degree in Interpretation clause. That is all my prayer.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: You see, Hon Minority Leader, if that is your intent, this is not the stage to move that particular amendment or raise your intention. The Bachelor of Laws would be interpreted in our context. It qualifies you to enter the professional practice training. So, it is when we get there that we will talk about a qualification to enter a professional practice training, that you can talk about its equivalent. So, at this particular—

4:35 p.m.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, if you go to the Functions of the Council and even the functions of the Director of Legal Education, we had made Object of Council — so go to clause 3 (g), it says:

“...evaluate courses of study provided by accredited universities to accord with appropriate recognition of legal qualifications obtained in institutions in other common law jurisdictions with analogous legal systems as Ghana for purposes of admission to the Bar;”

What I am saying is that already, there is a provision for the Council to make a determination of what degrees are analogous to our law degree for the purposes of being admitted to the Bar. So that issue is being addressed but I do agree with you that maybe when we get to the definition to make things very clear, we can make provision for that.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Let us move to the item numbered lxii, which is still on clause 48.

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, I beg to move, clause 48, subclause (2), Opening phrase, *delete* “A person in charge of the law degree programme of a university” and *insert* “A university that runs a law programme.”

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The item numbered lxiii on the *Order Paper*.

Mr S. Mahama: Hon Minority Leader, your amendment, please? It is standing in your name.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I beg to move, clause 48, *insert* the following new subclause:

“A person shall be eligible to apply for admission to the professional Law Practice Training Course only if that person has obtained an Honours degree in the Bachelor of Laws programme with a minimum classification of Second-Class Lower Division.”

Mr Speaker, I am abandoning the “minimum qualification of second class lower” to simply say that “has been awarded a Bachelor of Laws degree”, so that I do not come in with a second-class lower division. Mr Speaker, upon reflection, I realised that, as for life, some of the best practitioners were third-class students. Sometimes, one may struggle at the faculty, but situations may change at the professional level. So, I would abandon the “Second Class Lower Division” and maintain the rest of the amendment.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Are you improving on your amendment, or abandoning it in its entirety?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, give me a minute. The Chairperson and I are conferring. We are either improving or abandoning. He has asked me to check something. Just give me a second. Does he mean clause 48 (1)?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Which is clause 50 (1) in the Winnowing Committee’s document.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I think it answers the question, because the winnowed document says:

“The minimum requirement for the award of a Bachelor of Laws degree is the satisfactory completion of a number of courses of study that amount to a number of credit hours that the Council determines taking into consideration the general policy of the university in which the Bachelor of Laws degree programme operates regarding the number of credit hours required for completion.”

Mr Speaker, I think this is very fair. It considers the fact that one may be awarded a Bachelor of Laws degree without honours, but it still qualifies you for the professional. I think this is open enough.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, that is even the current practice.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I abandon the—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The proposed amendment in the item numbered lxvii on the *Order Paper* is accordingly abandoned.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Clause 48 as amended ordered to stand part of the Bill.

The item numbered lxiv on the *Order Paper*, which is clause 49?

Clause 49 — Form of and standards for examination.

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, I beg to move, *delete* and insert the following:

“Form of and standards for examination

- (49) (1) A university that runs a law programme shall set a uniform standard and format for the conduct of assessments.
- (2) The assessment of the law programme shall be designed so as to give effect to the objectives and intended learning outcomes of the law programme.
- (3) Without limiting subsection (2), the assessment of the law programme shall include a variety of assessment methods appropriate to the nature, level and objectives of the law programme.
- (4) The assessment methods applied shall
 - (a) provide an adequate and fair basis for determining whether a student has achieved the objectives and intended learning outcomes of the law programme; and

(b) test the ability of students to employ knowledge of fundamental principles of law to solve practical legal issues.”

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the proposed amendment is for your consideration. Any further proposal?

4:45 p.m.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, with respect, I do not want to rush to demand a further amendment on the condition that the Chairperson can explain to us what exactly he means by subclause 1:

“A university that runs a law programme shall set a uniform standard and format for the conduct of assessment.”

What exactly does he mean? Because the presumption is that a university would definitely, through approval from the academic Board, have its programme and standard of assessment. Now, what we know is that when this is done, it becomes part of the curriculum.

In Ghana today, we know that the grading system differs. What would be an A at the University of Cape Coast will not be the same as an A in the University of Ghana.

So, I just want clarity on exactly what you mean by uniform standard and format for the conduct of assessments.

Mr Shaibu Mahama: Mr Speaker, exactly what the Hon Minority Leader just said, safe to add that, apart from the clarity, there is also certainty. This clause seeks to give clarity and certainty, so any student knows that this is a form that I would be examined on, and these are the standards. So, it does not only set clarity, it also sets certainty, and these two go together as far as this clause is concerned.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, we only have to consider the use of “examination” in the headnote and “assessment” at the end of the clause. Should it be consistent? “Examination” and “assessment” may not be one and the same.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, you have a point there.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, so you can pick it up.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: I think the Chairperson of the Committee should take it up.

But Mr Speaker, again, to the extent that he argues that this provision is to ensure clarity and certainty, then why not include in it “which shall be known to the student”? Because if you are saying that there shall be a uniform and standard format for the conduct of assessment, you would agree with me that some of our universities do not have a transparent system where these things are already known to the student.

So, a student does not even know how the grading is done and cannot even challenge it. So, if you want to legislate on it, then I suggest to the Chairperson of the Committee, that we include in it and enrich the language after considering Mr Speaker's directive, and indicate that "which shall be communicated to the student". Because the student must know if that is what you seek to achieve.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I think the headnote must change from "examination" to "assessment".

Mr S. Mahama: Yes, I wanted to—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, move that amendment.

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, I move the amendment to change the headnote to *delete* "examination" and *insert* "assessment".

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, I will put the question.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I will then put a question on the proposed amendment by the Chairperson of the Committee.

Do you have something to say, Chairperson of the Committee?

Mr S. Mahama: No, the Hon Minority Leader had asked a question on certainty and clarity. And then he also requested that we *add* "this be

communicated to students". But I want to say that once it is a form and standard, it is expected that this will become a manual form. So, the standards and the forms will normally be in student manual. They are already communicated in the form of manuals, so that should take care of the concern that he has raised.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, the question is, if you *add* "communication to a student", can a student have a right to say that the standard has not been communicated to them, and therefore A, B, C, D? What is the usual practice?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Well, Mr Speaker, instead of that way, I think if I heard the Chairperson of the Committee right? He said that there is always a manual. So, I think that we can have it this way.

"A university that runs a law programme shall set a uniform standard and format for the conduct of assessment which shall be contained in its academic manual";

—because he made mention of the manual. You cannot say you have this uniform standard when there is no document that in itself enacts that, as a university, these are the manuals that communicate the standards of assessment that any student who gets admission and signs the acceptance letter and is enrolled knows that the set of manuals set out the standards of assessment and all that.

So, I think that if we want to maintain it, which I agree—It is good. It brings certainty. It brings clarity. Then we should rather add that “which shall be contained in the academic manuals to be made available to the student”. Or leave it there, “which shall be contained in the academic manual”, because having that written is very important.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Chairperson of the Committee. Very well, let me hear from the Hon Majority Leader before I come to the Chairperson.

Mr Ayariga: Well, I think the way that it is usually captured is to say, “for the conduct of assessments which shall be known by the students”.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, if you tie it that way, can a student say, they do not know?

Mr Ayariga: So, it will now be the duty of the university to show that it was communicated to the student, and that you do not remember or you did not pay attention at the time that it was being communicated—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Then let us have the correct rendition and would have no difficulty putting the question.

Yes, Prof Nyarko?

Prof K. Nyarko: Mr Speaker, in reference to the further proposed amendment by our Leader that, “to be known by the student”, I am thinking that it should be “shall be made known to the

students”, instead of saying be “known by the students”.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: You see, we do not draft in future tense. If we are going to use “be known”, then we should say so. But “to be” is a bit problematic.

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, “form of assessment” and “standards for assessment” are subject of regulations. The regulations will now tell what form the assessment should be and the standards should be. I do not think we should worry ourselves in trying to legislate how that form should be in this Bill. We can get that in the regulation.

4:55 p.m.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, with respect, I humbly hold this view that this must be communicated to the students in one way or the other. Normally, there is a student manual.

In other universities that I know of, when one gets in, they state the standard of assessment in the student manual. For some, one must submit three assignments to earn a certain credit hours, do in-person written examination, or when one gets a grade of 60 or 70, it is a pass, and all of that. These are communicated. So, once the person enrolls, they know that when they do this, this is what they get. So, I think that we should be rather clear instead of saying that we should leave it like that and regulate.

We know that sometimes we pass the laws and it takes several years for the

regulations to come. So, if we have the opportunity, even if it is superfluous, to indicate, let us do so to avoid ambiguity. The Leader said “which should be known” but I want to tweak it a bit that “which should be communicated through the student manual”. I heard that suggestion from an academic from this Side, who is proposing that we use the student manual language. So that is my proposal.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, I think we are making law and the law is setting standards. We should take into consideration that ignorance of the law cannot be taken to be an excuse. And in passage of law, we do not indicate categorically in the law that the law should be communicated to the general public before it becomes applicable. Here lies the case where we are making law, which will set form and standard of examining the students.

The students do not examine themselves. This law does not regulate only the students. It regulates the institutions that will be offering the Law, so they are being enjoined by this particular provision to set a uniform standard for assessment so that University of Ghana will not assess the bachelor students high and University of Science and Technology would assess them low. That is the essence of this particular provision so that there will be a standard.

That is why the provision is even indicating that a university that runs a Law programme shall set a uniform standard and format for conduct of

assessment. So, the way examinations are going to be conducted for these students in University of Science and Technology should not be different from Legon because they are all going to have a degree that enables them to do the practice training and we are talking about communication to students. I mean, this is between the universities.

Yes?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, with the greatest respect to you and the views you have expressed, I have my own difficulty. Mr Speaker, at the university, there are two key stakeholders: the university administration and its professors and the students. Students are the ones to be assessed. Mr Speaker, where I studied, when results are out, one has every right without petitioning to call the tutor and the script will be pulled out. And they have the standard of assessment records, and the person will go through with the professor and they can ask any question they have.

We all know that in the Ghanaian universities, one cannot do that. You would have to apply and it takes a very long time. Sometimes you dare not challenge even your marks. This legislation is introducing a new dispensation. One, we want to ensure standard. We want to ensure a uniform assessment by all the universities. It would be prudent, fair and right for this uniform assessment to be contained in a manual for a student to know. We cannot say that because it is meant for the regulator, a student who would be assessed must not know this. So, Mr

Speaker, for me, even if it is superfluous, we should legislate and let the language be clear that this must be contained in a student's manual so that the student becomes aware. The issue is not about being aware of the law or not, does not bring liability or otherwise. That is not the case. How can one be a student of a university and do not even know the standard of assessment or how to pursue a grievance.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, I would ask a rhetorical question.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, meaning we cannot answer? If it is rhetorical, it means we are not to answer you?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, you are not to answer. They are talking about standard among the universities that will run the course. For me, what I take this to be seeking to cure is that for the purposes of examining the students, a marking scheme should not even differ from one university to the other.

So, no university will say that if you do not get 90, you do not get A and another university will say if you get 70, that 70 amounts to A and marking schemes are developed after the examination. How are you going to communicate this to students? Meanwhile, these are standards that must be uniform. So, what is the new rendition?

Yes, Hon Rashid Pelpuo?

Dr Abdul-Rashid Hassan Pelpuo:

Thank you, Mr Speaker. My presentation is not going to be about the new rendition but to support what the Minority Leader is talking about, that it is important to put it in plain message in the brochure or the student book the grading criteria of the university. It is a normal thing to say that A means this or D means that so they know it and go into it. It does not matter whether in future, as a result of some kind of arrangement, one decides to change the marking scheme; that will be a local affair, but the standard should be there. I assume that we should have a standard criterion within which gradings of students can be done. So, when one is entering, they know that they have to hit 70 to get a B or one has to hit 75 or in my university, the University of Cape Coast, we have to get 80 to get an A and it was known to us.

5:05 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, that is what this particular rendition is trying to avoid because we are all going to enter the professional practice training school. So, they do not want a situation where among—So it says that a university that runs a Law programme. So long as you are running the Law programme, your standard should not be different from another university's standard.

That is why it says that “a university that runs a law programme shall set a uniform standard and format for the conduct of assessment.” But if the sense of the House is to add to it, I do not have a problem because I see this as avoiding the same problem that you raised, that a

person who attended the University of Cape Coast is graded 80 per cent as A. While someone who attended the University of Ghana is graded 70 per cent as an A. Meanwhile, they are all entering into the professional legal practise and training.

So why should there be differences in the standard among the universities that run the law programme? It is just communicating that if you are a university and want to run a law programme, your assessment standards and format must be uniform. That is the meaning I am getting from it. Whether you are a student in Cape Coast, Winneba, or Akatsi South, a uniform standard must be used to assess you. And the assessment format must also be the same. If it is an examination, every student must take it. One cannot assess based on an interim assessment (IA). If it is a written question, every student must take a written question and not an objective question.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, respectfully, let us read the rendition again.

“A university”, the word is “A”. “A university that runs a law programme shall set a uniform standard and format for the conduct of assessment”. So, we are dealing with the individual universities. It is not talking about a uniform standard of assessment by all the universities. That is not it. That is why it is in each institution. No, it is here. Unless there is some error in there—Please, respectfully.

Mr Speaker, even if the “A” there means plural, there is an overriding need to communicate the format of the assessment to the students. How can one be in a university where there is a uniform standard that has been approved by the academic board, which in itself has been approved by the regulator, and that student who has enrolled in that school does not know it? So it is important we put it in the law and give it finality.

Mr Speaker, in order not to waste time, I propose that we add the following to the assessment: “which shall be communicated in the student manual”. So the new rendition, therefore, shall read:

“A university that runs a law programme shall set a uniform standard and format for the conduct of assessment, which shall be contained in the student manual”.

That is the proposal. Thank you.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Mr John Darko: Mr Speaker, with respect, I have a further amendment to the clause. If we look at 51(2), it says: “the assessment of the law programme shall be designed so as to give effect to the—”

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So are you talking about clause 51?

Mr Darko: 51 of the new one.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We are now on 49, which is 50 in the new one. It is not even 51. Is it 51? All right.

Mr Darko: Mr Speaker, so where we have law programme, I believe that the framers actually intended law students, because if we look at 51(2) and 51(3)—Imagine if we are reading 3, “without limiting subsection 2, the assessment of the law programme”—No,

“the assessment of the law student, which shall include a variety of assessment methods appropriate to the nature, level, and objectives of the law programme”.

And if we look at 4, clearly it talks about the student. The assessment is the assessment of a student, not a law programme. So, I propose that in 51, wherever we have “law programme”, it should be changed to “law student” because we are assessing law students, not the law programme.

No, if we even look at the original one, we are talking about the form of assessment: long essay, short form questions, objective testing, and then case analysis. So it is a law student we are assessing here. We are not assessing the law programme. That is why the next one talks about grading and reviewing students’ grades. Assessing the law programme is the job of the commission and the council. So, let us read it well and see that I am correct.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Chairperson of the Committee?

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, I would urge my good Friend to abandon his proposal. The law programme as used here is most appropriate. It is not directed towards students.

“A university that runs a law programme shall set uniform standards and format for the conduct of assessments.

(2) The assessment of the law programme shall be designed so as to give effect to the objectives and intended learning outcomes of the law programme.”

It is not an assessment of the students. It is the programme itself, not students.

Mr Darko: Mr Speaker, I am saying that in terms of the first one, which is the 51 (1, the law programme, it should be allowed to stay. But subsequently, if we read it, right, this whole assessment is an assessment of students. Yes, the university runs a law programme, but the assessment is of students, not the programme. So, it does not make sense to say that the assessment of the law programme shall include a variety of assessment methods. Do we understand?

This one is the students we are assessing. If we look at the original Bill, clause 49, it talks about long essays, short form answers, objective testing, and a hypothetical case analysis. All of these are supposed to assess law students, not the law programme. So, if we abandon this, it will cause a lot of havoc.

5:15 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon John Darko, let us look at the provision carefully. I am doing what I intend not to do today. If you look at (2), it says “the assessment of the law programme shall be designed so as to give effect.” So if you replace the programme to be a student, then it will be, “the assessment of the law student shall be designed so as to give effect to the objects and intended learning outcome of the law student”.

Now, if you go further, (3) says “without limiting subsection 2, the assessment of the law programme shall include a variety of assessment methods appropriate to the nature, level and objective of the law student”.

Do you understand? It is the programme that have objective. So, if you read it all and you substitute “programme” with “student”, along the line, you may have a problem.

“(4) the assessment method applied shall

(a) provide an adequate and fair basis for determining whether a student...”,

So, it is a programme that will be used in determining the student. So, you cannot replace “programme” with “student”. It will throw the entire clause off gear.

So, let me hear from Prof Kingsley Nyarko.

Prof Kingsley Nyarko: If we read from the first paragraph to the fourth paragraph of clause 49, we see a progression. So, we first look at the programme, the assessment protocols that are used to assess the programme and its objectives. That is why when we come four, it is now judging the assessment of the students against the objective of the programme.

So, I do not see anything that deviates from what is captured here, because the four talks about providing an adequate and fair basis for determining whether a student has achieved the objectives and intended learning outcomes of the law programme, which has already been captured above with their appropriate tools.

So, I think that it should stand.

Mr John Darko — *rose* —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I recognise Hon Kyei.

You proposed it, so we will come to you later.

Dr F. K. Asamoah: Mr Speaker, if we look at the clause very well, the learning outcomes are for the programme. The objectives are also for the programme, but the assessment is for the student. That is why the earlier rendition, which we approved, says that we should put these standards in the student manual. So, I want to support the proposal of Hon John Darko that the assessment of the law student shall be designed so as to give effects of the

objectives and the intended learning outcomes of the programme. Because we cannot assess the programme to give an outcome of the programme. Remember, the assessment, which leads to the standardisation and accreditation is done by the council in collaboration with GTEC. But here, we are looking at assessing the students, that is why we cannot use just the law programme for both. So, for clause 49(1), we can keep “the law programme”. In clause 49(2), we can change it to “the law student”. Then, in clause 49(3), we can change “the first assessment of the law programme to student”. Then we keep “the learning level and objectives of the law programme”, because we are assessing the students, but the programme leads to objectives which we want to achieve.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Once this is talking about the programme and a student, and there is a mixed feeling that where in some places, “a programme” should be used and in some places “students” will be used, I may want to direct it to the drafters to use the appropriate terminology.

So, drafters, you are accordingly directed.

Clause 49 as amended ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Clause 50 — Grading Standards.

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, amendment proposed, subclause (1), *delete* and *insert* the following:

“(1) A university that runs a law programme shall adopt, in writing, uniform grading standards that ensure accuracy, validity, reliability and consistency in the evaluation of student performance in assessments.”

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the proposed amendment is for the consideration of the House.

Any further amendments?

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Chairperson of the Committee, the item numbered 16 (lxvi).

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, amendment proposed, sub clause (3), *delete* and *insert* the following:

“(3) A university that runs a law programme shall ensure consistency in the application of the written grading standards by the law lecturers of the law programme.”

I so move.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I suggest to the Chairperson that it is not enough to go the way he is going. Because we are dealing with different documents. So, if he is referring to the proposed amendment, he should link it to

the document and then read the new rendition in full so that we know the new rendition, because I am sure that it would offer the Members an opportunity —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I do not know why the Chairperson persistently refuse to read the two documents.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: So, he should read exactly —he wants to do a fast track?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The new renditions are contained in the Winnowing Committee's document. So, it is easy to link it up and read the new rendition.

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, you earlier admonished that we move on.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Mr S. Mahama: So, Mr Speaker, I am just following your directive. I will come back to basics.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, let me be your counsel. The fact that you gave directive did not mean that he should do the wrong thing.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: This will be very novel, that a Speaker will have a counsel while presiding. *[Laughter]*

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: I want to come to your aid. You said we should move on, but you did not tell him to do the wrong thing. That is the point I want him to know.

So, I think the Chairperson of the Committee has to do the right thing.

Mr S. Mahama: Respected Minority Leader, I will. *[Laughter]*

Mr Speaker, I think that for clause 50, we are all on the same page. It is on page 19 of the *Order Paper*, as clause 50 and then the original Bill is the same clause 50. Then the winnowed Bill has it as clause 53.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: No, it is clause 52, “a university shall run a law programme”.

Hon Members, the indication is that the Chairperson is fasting and it is after 5:00 p.m. So, the Vice Chairperson, you would have to be very proactive.

Hon Members, what is happening here is that if you look at the new document by the Winnowing Committee, they are proposing a deletion of the beginning of the clause up to “before shall” and they are inserting “a university that runs a law programme”. Then, at the end of the clause, they are adding “assessments”.

5:25 p.m.

So it reads:

“A university that runs a law programme shall adopt in writing uniform grading standards that ensure accuracy, validity, reliability, and consistency in the evaluation of students' performance in assessment.”

With this, I will ask if any Hon Member has a further proposed amendment.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, now to the entire clause 50.

Mr Darko: Mr Speaker, clause 52(2) where it reads that:

“(2) Where more than one law lecturer teaches a group of students, there shall be a reasonable and justifiable correlation among the grades awarded by the law lecturers to ensure fairness to students.”

Mr Speaker, I am a law teacher, and in some cases we teach different groups. I believe that we should not legislate this. I suggest instead of this particular provision, we state that where more than one law lecturer teaches a group of students, the lecturers shall set one set of questions for the students. That is my rendition. Mr Speaker, I believe that stating that we have to have a correlation among the grades awarded by the law lecturers to ensure fairness will be too difficult. Two different lecturers marking scripts, how are we going to ensure fairness among the grades? But once there is one set of questions, then it means that obviously there will be fairness.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: How do we relate that to clause 49 that we have taken? Setting a uniform standard and

format for conduct of assessment? The assessment involves examination.

Mr Darko: Mr Speaker, if we read this well, we will see that in the end we are talking about assessment of the students. We are saying that the lecturers should ensure a reasonable and justifiable correlation among the grades awarded by the various law lecturers.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Which of the provisions are you reading?

Mr Darko: Mr Speaker, I am reading the clause 52(2) “Grading standards”, of the Winnowing document. At best we can delete that, because we have different lecturers teaching, and we legislate that the grades should be similar.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So what is your concern? Let us listen to his concern.

Mr Darko: Mr Speaker, concern is that by this provision, we are saying that in awarding grades, there shall be reasonable and justifiable correlation among the grades awarded by the various law lecturers to ensure fairness to the students. I am saying that that would be very difficult. So my proposal that instead of saying that there shall be a reasonable and justifiable correlation among the grades, we should rather ensure that there is one set of questions.

My proposed amendment is that with more than one law lecturers, teaches a group of students, the lecturers shall set one set of questions.

Mr Speaker, I so propose.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Let us take the new rendition seriously. We have to move the rendition.

Mr Darko: My rendition is that where more than one law lecturer teach a group of students, the lecturers shall set one set of questions for the students.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, I see what is missing in the meaning this provision is conveying. This provision is saying that where several lecturers teach one course— it is one course, like Conveyancing and Drafting—

Let us say Hon Afenyo-Markin teaches Interpretation of statutes and Hon John Darko teaches Interpretation of Deeds. Where they have to set examination, the provision is saying that they must work together, so that when we are marking the scripts, they will coordinate in such a way that there will be a relationship in the marks that they award.

The group of students could be subdivided into subgroups, like Group A, Group B, Group C for the same course, perhaps because of numbers. So when they are setting the exams, they must synchronise it in such a way that in awarding the marks, one lecturer may not appear to be favourable to the group of students who came under his tutelage. That is what this provision is saying.

So, if we propose that amendment, it does not cure— it does not remedy the situation.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Practically, let us look at what happens. At the university in a particular year—

Very well.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I taught at UPSA. I was teaching the graduate class. We were three different lecturers, all taking the Business Law Programme. Somebody was doing MBA and others doing MA, but were taking the same programme. In the end, the understanding was that let us come together, the three of us, and set the questions, because it was the same, and then we had the marking scheme. Now, this was not the case in the previous academic year, where my students complained that I taught them, and then I was setting questions for the quizzes, then a different lecturer set and came to mark. So, the complaints more or less got addressed through the new system that was introduced.

Mr Speaker, I think what the respected Hon Member for Suame is seeking to do is to bring certainty here. Mr Speaker, in this provision, we are saying that where more than one law lecturer teaches a group of students—So, a group of students, they are about 100, one lecturer taking 50 and the other taking 50, there shall be reasonable and justifiable correlation. What correlation? One lecture sets a different question, I set my different question, and they say, let us correlate. No. Mr Speaker, this will become difficult to say that there shall be justifiable correlation among the grades awarded by the law lecturers.

Mr Speaker, with respect, we have already said in 49 or 48 that there shall be a uniform standard of assessment. That is why initially wanted him to —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: That is why said let us link this up.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, this is very problematic. This particular rendition. Mr Speaker —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So the university lecturers, where we have— You are not done? Alright.

5:34 p.m.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Yes. Mr Speaker, your parliamentarians here do a lot of part-time lecturing. It is only this year that I have not done part-time lecturing, but we like to teach.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Do you have a certificate to do part-time lecturing?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, I said it is only this academic year which started last year. I will not disobey Parliament. I have always taught based on my clearance here. I only got my clearance last week, so I will attach and apply. But in the previous years, I do not know of others who have been doing “*galamsey*”. I refused going to even the court. I do not sign any process in the firm because I want to wait for my certificate. Luckily for me, I got the Certificate of Profit last week, so I can now go and teach, go to the law firm and go to the court to practice. *[Interruption]*

Which fees, Mr Speaker? If a client has paid the fees to the law firm, can I not benefit from it? I will pay tax.

I think these two are very problematic. We should go by what Mr John Darko said. Otherwise, we defeat the principle of uniform standard of assessment. There will be chaos. I do not know how this correlation they are talking about can be achieved. They are also talking about “a justifiable”; what will be the test of that justification? So, if two or three different lecturers are teaching the same course, there should be one set of questions. The lecturers should come together as is done at UPSA and ensure that they set the questions. For the marking scheme, it will be standard. But where different questions are being set then group A will have different set of questions and then somebody is using the same grading, there will be a problem.

So, Mr Speaker, the Chairperson should have a look at it and then accept what Mr Darko is proposing.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, I think what is missing—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Let me hear Hon Anyimadu-Antwi. I will come to you.

Mr Kwame Anyimadu-Antwi: I knew the insinuation was casting behind him. Mr Speaker, first of all the universities are autonomous. The idea is that they should run Law programmes, and we would want what is happening in the University of Ghana to be consistent with what is happening at the Kwame

Nkrumah University of Science and Technology (KNUST).

Mr First Deputy Speaker: But I said this earlier and it was overruled that it is not possible.

Mr Anyimadu-Antwi: Mr Speaker, we do not want the situation where one lecturer will be teaching in different schools, but because he might think that the students in the other school are not performing well, the standard of examination and what not may be lower than another university, and that should not be tolerated. We cannot get one set of questions for all the universities because every university, even if one is a lecturer and is assessing different students, the person will look at the standard but will set different questions. The person will set different questions but has to make sure that the questions that are set must be at the same level with what is done in the other school. That is why he was talking about a lecturer teaching in several schools.

The lecturer has to make sure that he brings it to a level, and assessment of the universities would be done to ascertain that they are all at a level.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I said this when we were looking at clause 49, but the argument was that every university would have its standard, which I beg to differ. For the purposes of running the Law course, they are supposed to have same standard and format. Not that University of Cape Coast will grade based on 80, University of Ghana will grade based on 70. But I was defeated.

Mr Anyimadu-Antwi: Mr Speaker, on clause 49 you had already closed the curtain and you referred it to the drafters. But I was with you on all fours when you said that we are rather talking about the assessment of programmes and not the assessment of students. I perfectly agreed with you because we should have a body that must be assessing the programme. It is not only students we are going to assess. We are going to assess the programme as well. So, where it is programme, it is programme, and if it is students, it is students. But Mr Speaker, you drew the curtain down and I do not know what the drafters will say.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We should get the understanding of this Bill very well. All the universities running the Law programme are going to be accredited. At the end of the day, the aim is that students that will qualify from the various universities are entering into the same level of the professional Law course.

So, how is the programme that is being run in University of Cape Coast, University of Ghana and the University of Development Studies being assessed so that students in one university will not be shortchanged as against students of another university? So, they are talking about a standard format of assessing. If you do not assess the programme, how can you determine whether the programme run by KNUST to qualify students to come to the professional practise training is the same standard that University of Ghana is running? But you talk about assessment of student rather than assessment of the programme.

Advisedly, I referred it to the drafters, so we have crossed that particular level. So now there is an issue about clause 52 (2), which reads, “where more than one law lecturer teaches a group of students, there shall be a reasonable and justifiable correlation among the grades awarded by the law lecturers to ensure fairness to students.” They are not referring to students of a particular university. I do not understand this to mean students of a particular university.

5:45 p.m.

But they are talking about grading among the universities that are running the course will be taught by various lecturers. In grading the students—that is why the course is talking about grades. Grade is here, it says:

“Where more than one law lecturer teaches a group of students, there shall be a reasonable and justifiable correlation among the grades.”

Well, let me hear the Majority Chief Whip.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, in all humility, the introductory phrase “where more than one lecturer teaches a group of students”, presupposes that it is a reference to a particular school, an accredited institution. Now, what is being implied here is that there may be one or more lecturers teaching one course. What is creating the problem is that it should be one course.

The intendment is that this group of lecturers, in assessing the students at the

end of their tutelage, should be able to have a certain correlation. But what is also creating the problem is the introduction of justifiable correlation. I think that adjective is misplaced. Because we speak of a uniform standard. So, the intendment of this provision is to the effect that there must be an established uniform standard of assessing this group of students taught by these several lecturers in this particular programme. For instance, let me speak of advocacy; the Hon John Darko teaches some part of advocacy, the Hon Anyimadu- Antwi teaches some part of that same course, then Osahen Afenyo-Markin also teaches some part of a programme. The intendment of this provision is that when at the end of the programme they want to assess the students, there must be a certain standard way of ensuring that when they set their examinations, and they are marking the students, they will not apply different standards in the award. So that the examinations will be set, a marking scheme will be provided, and one of them can have a uniform way of assessing them. So, what is missing here is one course.

Mr Speaker, if your rendition is what it is, then the entire drafting will have to be redone. In applying your rendition, it means taught, for instance.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, in the scenario you have narrated, will the students be writing one and the same examination?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Yes, they will be writing one and the same examination.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Once they are writing one and the same examination, you are only talking about grading. This has nothing to do with the setting of questions, because whether the questions are set by one of the lecturers or all the lecturers, that is the examination that all the students in different groups are going to write. But it is not possible that you have only one lecturer who will be marking all the scripts.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, it is possible that the three of them can set the examination questions. It is published, administered, and there is a marking scheme. Perhaps Senior Anyimadu-Antwi is the one who has the time—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: But I do not think that is what they are talking about, because if it is one lecturer who is going to mark the examination, they cannot be talking about reasonable correlation. Because it is one and the same person who is marking. So, if one and the same person is marking, who is he going to do that reasonable correlation with?

Mr Dafeamekpor: With the one or more lecturers—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: But he is the only one marking. This particular provision envisages a situation where it may not be one person marking. So, in grading, there must be a correlation between a grade that will be given by Hon John Darko, a grade that will be given by Osahen Afenyo-Markin, a grade that will be given by Prof Kingsley

Nyarko, and a grade that will be given by Hon Anyimadu-Antwi.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Yes, but it has to be the same course.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Because they are marking with the same scheme, there should be a correlation. That is what I understand this to mean. Since we agree that the examination questions will be one and the same.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Yes. So, it is not in different schools, but in the same school, and the same course. We may have to direct that this clause be stood down, and we tidy it up.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, let me hear from the Chairperson of the Committee. I will come to the Ranking Member, and I will come to you. Then we can draw down the curtains.

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, from the arguments my Colleagues have all raised, they seem to be zooming in on the fact that it is more than one lecturer teaching one course. This clause goes beyond that. It did not mention one course or one subject. It says: “where more than one law lecturer teaches a group of students”. That is where it ends. That subject could vary. So, my good self, John, and Senior Kwame could be teaching one group of people different courses or different subjects. That is the other aspect of it.

So, the intendment of this is to say that when three of us—because we are talking about standards, when three of us

are teaching a group of people, whether he is teaching Mathematics, he is teaching English, and he is teaching Chemistry, there has to be a certain correlation. Your grading should not be high up, and mine should be low. That is the intendment of this.

So, it does not restrict us to one course. What I am just saying is that this clause did not say that when three of us are teaching the same group of people the same course. But it says: “when more than one law lecturer teaches a group of students”, Mr Speaker, end it there and interpret it. Those three did not say that, for instance, when more than one lecturer is teaching interpretation. But more than one lecturer can be teaching Interpretation, Family Law, or whatever. So, it says that in grading, because a lecturer is teaching the same group of people, it should be so correlated that there should not be any huge variance in terms of the grading per the standards that were set in the previous clause.

So, please, let us not read this to mean that two or more lecturers are teaching the same course or subject. It could be different subjects, but the fact that you are teaching the same group of people, the grading and variation should not be so much.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: If you look at the subclause (3), it says:

“The university that runs a law programme shall ensure consistency in the application of the written grading standard by the law lecturers of the law programme.”

Mr S. Mahama: Yes. It does not mean one particular course.

5:55 p.m.

Mr Darko: If you have this provision, then the subclause (3) is not necessary.

It should be deleted because the interpretation the Chairperson is giving to sub-clause (2) is so absurd. He is saying that we have different lecturers teaching different courses, right? So, we have somebody teaching Interpretation, someone teaching Advocacy, and someone teaching Conveyancing and Drafting. The grades should be the same or similar; we should coordinate it. Different lecturers teaching the different courses, we cannot say that there has to be some correlation among the grades. No. If the students are not doing well in Conveyancing and Drafting and they are failing, that is it. If we teach Law, we know that we can have students passing in one class, and in another class, there will be a complete failure. And it happens. So, how do we correlate that?

So, his interpretation is so absurd, I do not even want him to bring it. This one, what it is trying to say is that two or more different lecturers teaching the same course, say, Conveyancing and Drafting, in my understanding, because we may have groups A, B, or C, we have to ensure that the grades given to these students in these different groups are coordinated. My point is that, this is going to be a very difficult thing to do, different lecturers marking a script. If one sets a standard by way of same question, same marking scheme, then

one would get what one is looking for. But we cannot legislate that we should coordinate the grades. That would be absurd.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I even think if the sub-clause (3) comes before sub-clause (2), it makes it clearer, because the subclause (3) says:

“A university that runs a Law programme shall ensure consistency in the application of the written grading standards by the Law lecturers of the Law programme”.

So, it means that there must be some consistency in the standard. It means that there is a grading standard, and by that grading standard, if we are going to mark some students, and I am also going to mark some students, there must be some correlation. Correlation in the sense that sometimes they may set the standard, but based on the examination outcomes, certain things happen, and the lecturers know. So, in doing all those things, there must be some correlation.

Hon Members, I think we have to defer clause 50, in view of the fact that today is Friday, and I am here alone.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, let me draw attention to subclause (3). Even the “written grading standards” is nebulous. There is nothing like written grading standards. We have grading standards. So, the adjective “written” to qualify grading standards in itself should go. But I agree with you that we may as well delete sub-clause (2) and make it 50(1), 50(2), so that the sub-clause (3) becomes sub-clause (2). If it stays like that, it conveys every meaning under the sun that—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, with all due respect, we will defer the consideration of clause 50.

We have sat beyond five hours, so, I will proceed to adjourn the House.

ADJOURNMENT

The House was adjourned at 5:58 p.m. till Tuesday, 24th February, 2026, at 2:00 p.m.

Editor's Note

This *Official Report* was adopted by the House on 3rd March, 2026.